

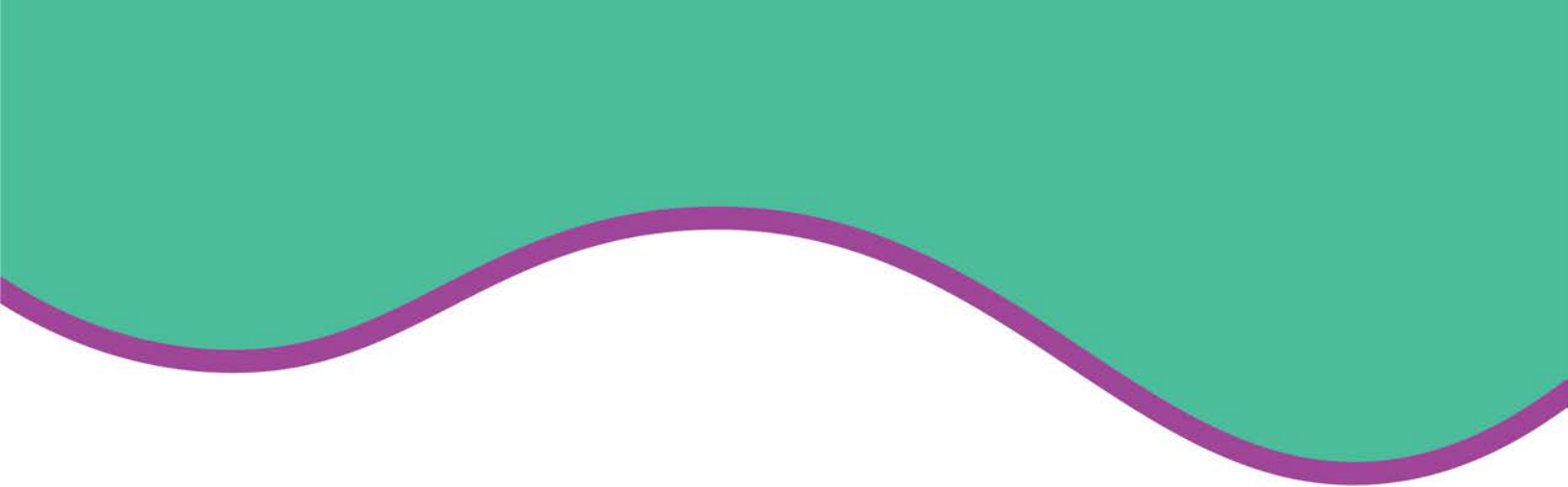


CHILD CARE ACTION PLAN



Township of
Langley
Est. 1873

December 2021



The 2021 Child Care Action Plan was endorsed by Township of Langley Council on December 13, 2021.

Acknowledgments

The Child Care Action Plan was developed and enriched through the participation of many caring and engaged community members. Thank you to everyone – parents, guardians, child care providers, early childhood educators, and local stakeholders – that shared their experiences, thoughts, and hopes for the future.

The Child Care Action Plan was prepared for the Township of Langley by CitySpaces Consulting Ltd.

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Executive Summary

Child care is an important element of complete, sustainable communities. The Child Care Action Plan aims to improve access to affordable, quality child care that meets the diverse needs of all Township children and families.

Currently, many families in the Township do not have access to child care that meets their needs. With nearly 20,000 children aged 12 and under and less than 4,000 licensed child care spaces, the Township has only about 1 licensed space per 5 children aged 12 and under. Many families in the Township are on child care waitlists, and most feel that child care is unaffordable. Families requiring child care outside of regular business hours or with children needing extra support face even greater challenges accessing quality care.

Improving the current situation will require, among other actions, a substantial increase in the number of licensed child care spaces in the community. The Action Plan sets an ambitious target of creating more than 10,000 new spaces over the next ten years. As the Township alone is not responsible for creating these spaces, achieving this target will require bold action from other levels of government and collaboration across the public, private, and non-profit sectors.

To support space creation, address related challenges, and harness emerging opportunities, the Child Care Action Plan establishes five priorities:

1. Increase the number of licensed child care spaces
2. Improve child care affordability
3. Strengthen partnerships and collaboration
4. Address staffing challenges
5. Enhance before and after-school recreation programming

Each priority area identifies concrete actions for the Township to undertake over the next five years. These actions are intended to reflect the Township's role as a local government, and will be pursued in collaboration with other stakeholders.

Introduction

Background

In 2018, the Province of BC announced \$1 billion over three years to support the transition to a universal child care system. As part of this funding, the Province established a grant program to support municipalities in creating action plans that identify local needs and priorities for child care. In 2019, the Township received a grant under this program and initiated the process to prepare the Child Care Action Plan.

The purpose of the Child Care Action Plan is to improve access to affordable, quality child care throughout the community. It identifies ten-year space creation targets, along with five priorities and related actions to pursue in collaboration with other stakeholders over the next five years.

Creating the Plan

The work to prepare the Child Care Action Plan was extensive, involving policy and best practice research, data collection and analysis, and community engagement with parents and guardians, child care providers, and other stakeholders.

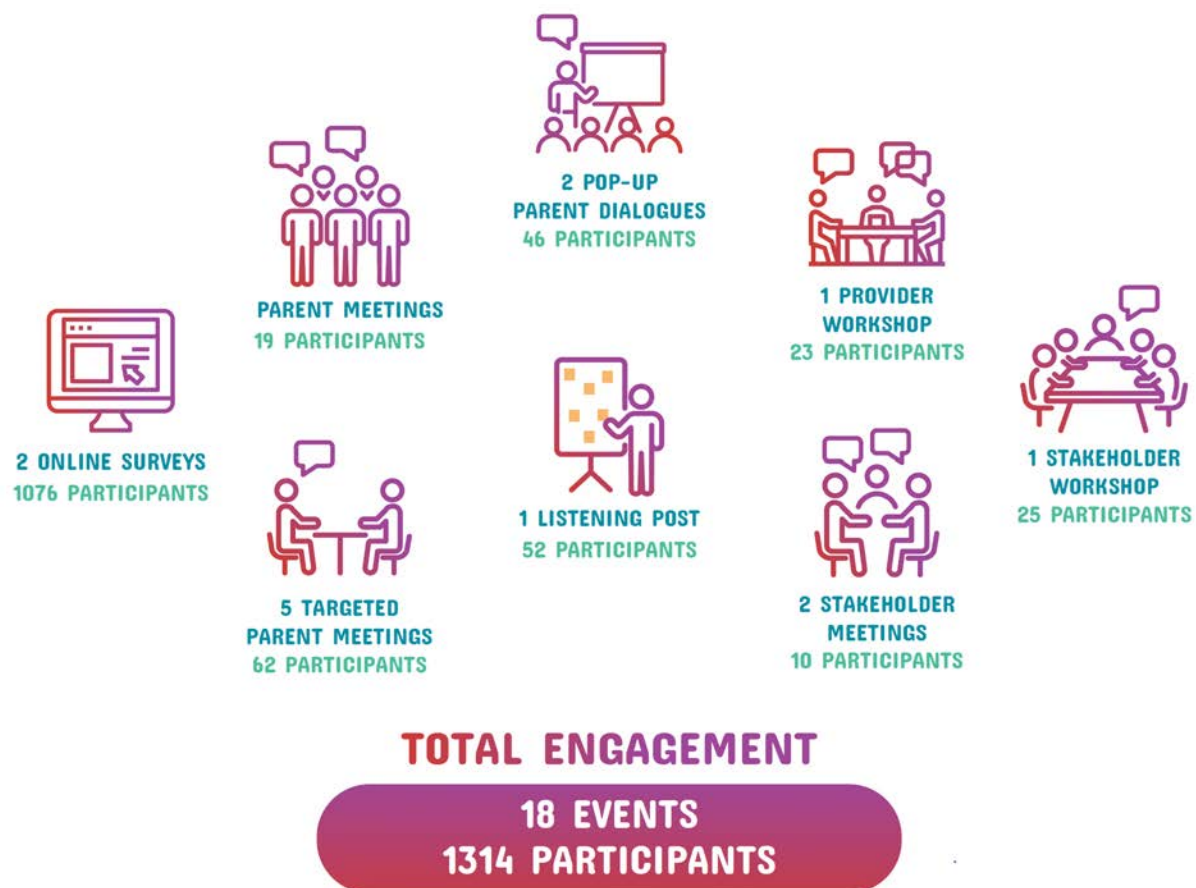
The quantitative data highlighted in this report was obtained from a variety of sources including the 2006, 2011, and 2016 Census of Canada, Metro Vancouver, the Fraser Health Authority, the Langley Child Care Resource and Referral (CCRR) Centre, and the Ministry of Children and Family Development (MCFD).

The community engagement provided insight into the current child care situation in Langley, key concerns and priorities, and possible opportunities and areas for change. Engagement in the first phase of the project was undertaken in partnership with Langley City. In total, 1,314 people were engaged through 18 activities:

- ★ Four parent meetings and five targeted parent meetings with underserved families;
- ★ Two pop-up parent dialogues took place at two locations;
- ★ One listening post with passive activity boards was available for parents and guardians to complete on their own time;

- ★ Two workshops took place, the first for community stakeholders, and the second for child care providers. Additional meetings took place with stakeholders unable to attend the workshop; and
- ★ Two surveys - one targeted to parents and guardians and another to child care operators and providers.

A complete summary of the engagement activities and results is included in the Phase One Community Engagement Report (under a separate cover).



In the second phase of the project, the public and local stakeholders were invited to review and provide feedback on a draft of the Child Care Action Plan.

Context

Affordable, accessible, quality child care is an integral element of complete, sustainable communities and is foundational to early childhood development. The points below highlight just some of the benefits of an accessible, quality child care system.

- ★ Accessible child care can result in increased labour force participation, especially among women. Following the establishment of a universal child care system in Quebec in 1997, for example, there has been a large increase of Quebec women in the workforce whose youngest child was under the age of three (from 61% in 1996 to 80% in 2016).¹
- ★ The quality of the environments in which children spend their time is critical to their development and school readiness. Children's early experiences can have a lasting impact on their lifelong social and physical health and academic success.² Research shows that the first 1,000 days – the period from conception to the end of a child's second year – has the greatest potential to affect health and well-being throughout the child's life.³ This emphasizes the importance of quality child care, as it plays a vital role in the growth and development of young children.

Early Childhood Development in Langley

Early childhood developmental vulnerability is increasing in Langley. Data between 2016 and 2019 indicates that 30% of the Kindergarten population in the Township is vulnerable on at least one of the five scales of the Early Development Instrument, compared to 21% between 2004 and 2007.⁴

¹ Melissa Moyser and Anne Milan, "Fertility Rates and Labour Force Participation Among Women in Quebec and Ontario", *Statistics Canada*, 2018. For comparison, in Ontario (chosen for its similarities to Quebec in population size and composition, geography, and economy), the participation rate among women whose youngest child was under three rose four percentage points, from 66% in 1996 to 70% in 2016.

² Human Early Learning Partnership. Early Development Instrument [EDI] report. Wave 7 Community Profile, 2019. Langley School District (SD35). Vancouver, BC: University of British Columbia, Faculty of Medicine, School of Population and Public Health; February 2020. Available from: http://earlylearning.ubc.ca/media/edi_w7_communityprofiles/edi_w7_communityprofile_sd_35.pdf

³ Moore T, Arefadib N, Leone V, West S. The first thousand days - our greatest opportunity [policy brief]. Melbourne, Australia: Royal Children's Hospital, Murdoch Children's Research Institute, Centre for Community Child Health; 2018 Mar. Available from: <https://www.rch.org.au/uploadedFiles/Main/Content/ccchdev/1803-CCCH-Policy-Brief-28.pdf>.

- ★ Child care has a proven positive impact on local economic activity and employment. Investments in the child care sector create new jobs and contribute to economic gains through increased productivity, employee recruitment and retention, and lower spending in other areas. Based on data from Statistics Canada, the child care sector in BC is estimated to boost GDP by \$1.63 per dollar of increased expenditure as compared with \$0.86 for the average industry and \$1.04 for other provincial government spending.⁵



⁴ Human Early Learning Partnership, Early Years Development Instrument, 2020. The Early Development Instrument (EDI) measures the developmental health of the Kindergarten population on the following five scales: physical health and well-being; social competence; emotional maturity; language and cognitive development; and communication skills and general knowledge. Vulnerability is assessed for each of the five EDI scales. Children whose scores fall below the vulnerability cut-off on a particular EDI scale are said to be vulnerable in that area of development. Children who are vulnerable on at least one of the five scales is used as a summary measure. Children represented by this summary measure may be vulnerable on only one scale or may be experiencing vulnerabilities on two, three, four or all five scales of the EDI.

⁵ Robert Fairholm and Lynell Anderson, Socio-Economic Impact Analysis of the \$10aDay Child Care Plan for British Columbia, January 2017.

Types of Child Care

There are four different types of legal child care in BC:

- ★ **Licensed child care:** Licensed child care facilities are monitored and regularly inspected by regional health authorities. They must meet specific requirements for health and safety, staffing qualifications, record keeping, space and equipment, child-to-staff ratios, and programming. Licensed child care includes the following:
 - ▶ **Group child care – under 3 years old:** maximum group size is 12 children; setting is in a community-based facility or centre
 - ▶ **Group child care – 2.5 years old to school age:** maximum group size is 25 children; setting is in a community-based facility or centre
 - ▶ **Group child care – school age (before-and-after school care):** maximum group size is 24 children from Kindergarten and Grade 1 or 30 children from Grade 2 and older with no Kindergarten or Grade 1 children present; setting is in a community-based facility or centre
 - ▶ **Multi-age child care:** maximum group size is 8 children; setting is in a community-based facility or centre
 - ▶ **In-home multi-age child care:** maximum group size is 8 children; setting is in the child care provider's own home
 - ▶ **Family child care:** maximum group size is 7 children; setting is in the child care provider's own home
 - ▶ **Preschool – 2.5 years old to school age:** maximum group size is 20 children; setting is a community-based facility or centre
 - ▶ **Occasional child care:** maximum group size is 16 children (if children under 36 months are present) or 20 children (if no children under 36 months are present); setting is a community-based facility or centre

- ★ **Registered licence-not-required child care:** These care providers do not require a licence but they must have registered with a Child Care Resource and Referral Centre. To register, operators must have completed: criminal record checks, character references, a home safety assessment, first aid training, child care training courses or workshops. Registered care providers also have access to support, training, resources and group liability insurance. Maximum group size is only two children or a sibling group who are not related to them; setting is in the child care provider's own home.
- ★ **Licence-not-required child care:** These child care providers are not registered or licensed and are not monitored or inspected. Unlicensed child care providers do not have to meet health or safety standards. Legally, the child care providers can care for up to two children (or a sibling group) who are not related to them. Setting is in the child care provider's own home.
- ★ **In-child's-own-home care:** This unlicensed care is when parents arrange for child care at home – like a nanny or a baby-sitter. Children from other families cannot be included in this care.



Roles and Responsibilities

Child care is a shared responsibility among all levels of government and requires involvement from private and non-profit sector organizations. Although the Township currently operates three licensed preschool programs, as a local government its primary roles are to:

- ★ Identify appropriate locations for child care through land use planning and regulations;
- ★ Ensure health and safety standards for child care buildings are met through its permitting and business licensing regulations;
- ★ Compile and share information that identifies local child care needs;
- ★ Convene stakeholders to enhance coordination and collaborative action; and,
- ★ Engage other levels of government to influence policies and decisions.

Other parties involved in child care include:

FEDERAL GOVERNMENT

In 2017, the federal government announced the Multilateral Early Learning and Child Care Framework to make enhancements to provincial and territorial early learning and child care systems. This Framework has been implemented through a three-year bilateral agreement, which outlines the unique early learning and child care needs to be addressed in each province or territory and the funding allocation for each jurisdiction. The British Columbia Early Learning and Child Care Agreement, which was in effect until March 31, 2020 (and may be renewed as per the terms of the agreement), resulted in a yearly financial contribution of approximately \$51 million.⁶ The Province of BC has drafted an Action Plan to ensure the funds provided under this bilateral agreement are allocated to specific areas of investment.

PROVINCIAL GOVERNMENT

The provincial government regulates child care in BC through the *Community Care and Assisted Living Act*, the *Child Care Licensing Regulation*, and various standards of practice. Together, these prescribe licensing, facility, employee, and general care requirements. The Province supports licensed child care providers with the costs of delivering quality child care programs, provides funding to create new licensed child care spaces, and supports low-income parents and guardians with the costs of accessing child care.⁷ In 2018, the Province

⁶ Canada - British Columbia Early Learning and Child Care Agreement, <https://www.canada.ca/en/early-learning-child-care-agreement/agreements-provinces-territories/british-columbia.html>

⁷ Ibid.

announced that it intends to transition BC to a universal child care system, which would provide affordable, quality child care to every family that wants or needs it.

FRASER HEALTH

Fraser Health Authority is responsible for licensing and inspecting child care facilities. It prevents risk of harm to the children in care by working proactively with applicants for a community care facility licence. The Licensing Officers assess all applicants and managers, conduct inspections to monitor compliance with the legislated requirements, and conduct facility risk assessments.

LANGLEY CHILD CARE RESOURCE AND REFERRAL

The Child Care Resource and Referral (CCRR) program offers free consultation, support, assistance with affordable child care benefit applications and referral services to parents and guardians seeking child care in Langley. The program supports child care providers through information, outreach, a resource library as well as networking and learning opportunities. The Langley CCRR program is operated by Langley Community Services Society.

LANGLEY SCHOOL DISTRICT NO. 35

School Districts do not have a formal mandate to provide child care, but the Langley School District supports the local child care system by leasing space within schools and on school property for child care facilities. The Langley School District offers various early learning programs, including StrongStart BC at six Township elementary schools. A free, play-based, drop-in program, StrongStart BC provides rich environments designed for early learning and development.

CHILD CARE OPERATORS

Child care is provided by for-profit entities and non-profit organizations. Private and non-profit child care providers are involved in all aspects of child care development, and play many important roles as landowners, developers, builders and investors. Licensed providers must operate child care facilities in compliance with all provincial regulations, which prescribe the standards of care, including the child-to-staff ratios and staff training requirements.

Early Childhood Educators

Many types of child care require that staff have an early childhood education certificate. Training from an approved program that meets provincial standards is needed to work as a certified early childhood educator in BC.

The following programs are currently offered through the provincial government to reduce child care fees for families.

Affordable Child Care Benefit

The Affordable Child Care Benefit replaces the previous Child Care Subsidy. Families with a pre-tax income of up to \$111,000 are eligible. The amount varies based on the child care type, reason for care, and family income.

Child Care Fee Reduction Initiative

The Child Care Fee Reduction Initiative (CCFRI) lowers the cost of child care by providing funding directly to child care providers. Parents and guardians do not apply – child care providers are responsible for applying, with participation voluntary. As of 2020, 68 child care centres in the Township of Langley opted into this program.

Young Parent Program

Through the Young Parent Program, parents under the age of 25 may qualify for help with child care while completing high school. Parents and guardians can apply for this funding or child care providers can be designated as Young Parent Programs.

Universal Child Care Prototype Sites

The provincial and federal government are partnering together to create 50 Universal Child Care Prototype Sites that offer child care for a maximum of \$200/month, per child for full-time enrolment during business hours. For some low-income families, child care may be provided for free. As of April 2020, there are no Universal Child Care Prototype Sites in the Township of Langley.

Child care providers can access a variety of funding through the provincial government, including:

- ★ Child Care BC Maintenance Fund;
- ★ Child Care BC New Spaces Fund;
- ★ Child Care Operating Fund (includes the Child Care Fee Reduction Initiative);
- ★ Child Care Minor Capital Funding Program;
- ★ Start-up Grants; and
- ★ Early Childhood Educator Wage Enhancement.

Current Township Policy and Practice

Child care is an emerging policy priority for many local governments. As this document represents the Township of Langley's first Child Care Action Plan, it is important to understand the existing policy and regulatory framework. The Township's Official Community Plan (OCP), which guides growth and development through land use policies, includes several policies specific to child care:

- ★ **2.4.4:** For high-density residential developments, incorporate social amenities such as daycare centres, a range of housing affordability options, and public art as integral components of proposed developments.
- ★ **3.2.8:** Facilitate the development of childcare, preschool spaces, and elder care in the community. This may involve including such facilities in new residential and mixed-use developments.
- ★ **3.2.9:** Consider locating new group childcare centres, public schools, and seniors' facilities in close proximity to each other, and promote joint programming and volunteer opportunities.

Community and Neighbourhood Plans, which guide growth and change in specific communities and neighbourhoods, also include location policies for child care.

From a regulatory perspective, child care is a permitted use in many of the Township's zones, including various residential and commercial zones. This permissive framework helps facilitate the creation of child care across the Township.

Currently, the Township does not provide child care funding mechanisms to encourage the development of new child care spaces (e.g. funding through community amenity contributions).

With regard to programming, the Township currently operates three licensed preschools: Curiosity Grove (Walnut Grove Community Centre), Little Wise Guys (W.C. Blair Recreation Centre), and Wee Willow Bees (Willoughby Community Centre). The Township also operates Active Beyond the Bell, a recreation program that runs for two hours after dismissal in the gymnasium of certain elementary schools in the Township of Langley.

Current Child Care Coverage Rates

Child care coverage rates, or spaces per 100 children, are determined by dividing the number of licensed child care spaces by every 100 children aged 12 and under. As of January 2020, there were a total of 3,954 licensed child care spaces, delivered through 197 child care programs, and approximately 19,984 children aged 12 and under in the Township, resulting in a coverage rate of 19.8 spaces per 100 children. This coverage rate is lower than the national coverage rate of 27.2 spaces per 100 children aged 12 and under, and far below what is considered an accessible child care system for families.

Table 1 indicates the child care coverage rates for the three main age groups. As shown, the coverage rate is lowest for school aged children (6-12 years), followed by infant/toddlers (under 3 years).

Table 1: Child Care Coverage Rate, Township of Langley, 2020

Township of Langley			
Age Group	Children	Child Care Spaces	Child Care Spaces Per 100 Children
Under 3 years	4,600	745	16.2
3 - 5 years	4,271	2,079	48.7
6 - 12 years	11,113	1,130	10.2
0 - 12 years	19,984	3,954	19.8

Source: 2016 Census (Township Community Level Custom Data, Age in Single Years Data), Township Building Permit Data, Fraser Health Authority

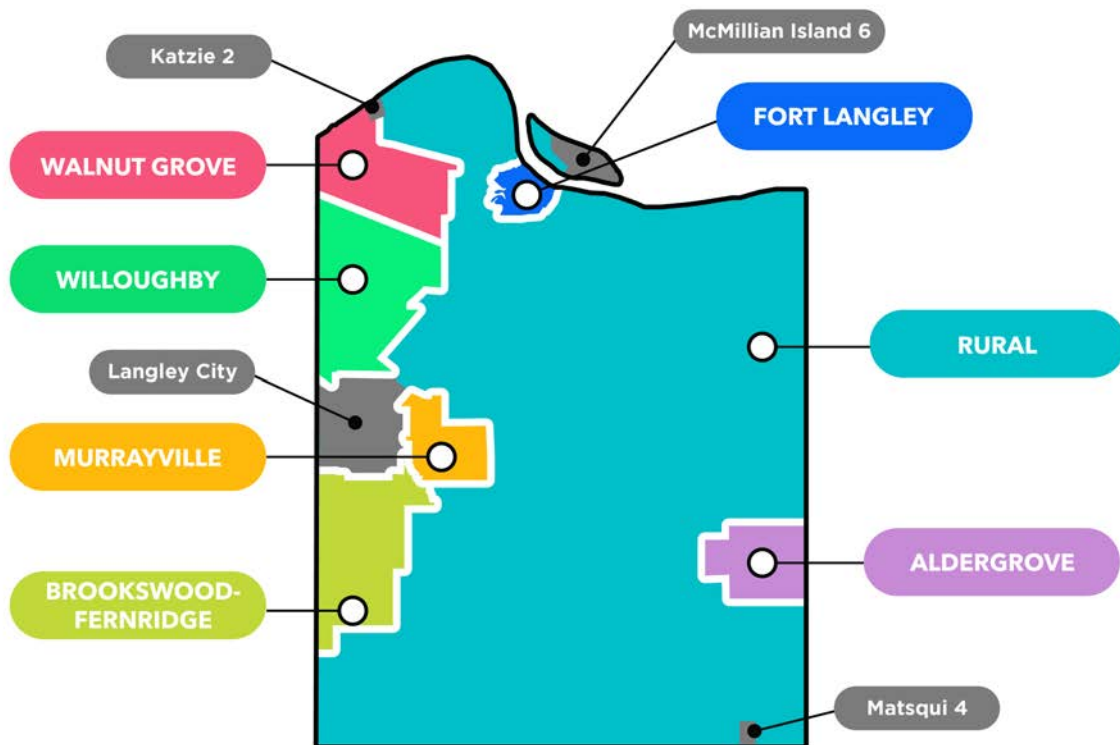
Table 2 indicates the child care coverage rates at the community level (for all children aged 0 to 12). As shown, coverage rates in Aldergrove, Brookwood-Fernridge, Walnut Grove, and the Rural communities are lower than the Township average of 19.8 spaces per 100 children. That said, due to its relatively large population of children, Willoughby may have the highest number of children unserved, with over 7,000 children aged 12 and under and less than 2,000 licensed child care spaces.

Table 2: Child Care Coverage Rate, Community-Level Analysis, Children 0 to 12, 2020

Township of Langley Community	Children Aged 0-12	Child Care Spaces	Child Care Spaces Per 100 Children
Aldergrove	2,179	331	15.2
Brookwood-Fernridge	1,819	253	13.9
Fort Langley	476	165	34.7
Murrayville	1,323	286	21.6
Walnut Grove	3,954	770	19.5
Willoughby	7,282	1,903	26.1
Rural	2,951	246	8.3

Source: 2016 Census (Township Community Level Custom Data, Age in Single Years Data), Township Building Permit Data, Fraser Health Authority

TOWNSHIP OF LANGLEY COMMUNITIES



Areas in grey are jurisdictions outside of the Township

More detailed coverage rate information, including community level coverage rates for each age group, is included in the Needs Assessment (Appendix A).

Implications of Low Coverage Rates

Low coverage rates can indicate a lack of child care spaces to meet demand. This can lead to a number of consequences, including:

- ★ Higher costs and less incentive for quality care
- ★ Lower labour force participation, especially for women
- ★ Longer travel distances and more time wasted to access care
- ★ Higher likelihood that families make unsafe care choices



Child Care Strengths, Gaps, and Trends

Strengths, gaps, and trends related to child care in the Township were identified from the background research, data analysis, and community engagement. This baseline provides a foundational understanding of child care in the Township, and facilitated the development of priorities and actions that build on existing assets and address current needs.

Refer to the Needs Assessment (Appendix A) for a more detailed overview of these strengths, gaps, and trends.

- ★ **Availability of Child Care:** More space is needed to address current demand and the Township's projected population growth. Space needs are greatest for infant/toddler (under 3 years) and school aged (6 - 12 years) care, and the needs vary in different communities.
- ★ **Cost of Child Care:** High costs are an access barrier for many families. Some parents and guardians end up spending over \$1,000 a month per child for care.

"We need more child care badly. We were on a waitlist for two years before getting in and others struggle to get care in our area." – Langley Parent/Guardian

"I will have to give up my career after my maternity leave as I cannot afford full-time childcare for two kids. I will have to look for a new job after 10+ years of working hard to be in my position." – Langley Parent/Guardian

- ★ **Location of Child Care:** Parents and guardians want child care close to home and, when applicable, close to their child's school, but many families cannot access care in these preferred locations. Proximity to public transit is important for child care staff and some families.
- ★ **Flexibility of Child Care:** There are very limited licensed child care options for families that need care outside of regular business hours.

"I am a shift worker (a nurse) and need child care that is flexible and will take them as early as 6am." – Langley Parent/Guardian

"Not everyone's schedule is a 9-5 job and sometimes the hours imposed (by child care providers) are not realistic." – Langley Parent/Guardian

- ★ **Child Care for Children Requiring Extra Support:** Care options for children needing extra support are limited and more expensive. Child care providers face challenges in finding qualified staff for children requiring extra support.

- ★ **Staffing:** Recruiting and retaining qualified staff is a significant challenge for child care providers, and constrains their ability to provide more space.

"Child care for children with special needs is lacking, I receive a subsidy for my son with special needs, he was in an after school day care with his sister but he was asked to leave because they didn't have the means to care for him." – Langley Parent/Guardian

"The problem isn't solely about opening NEW spaces. The problem IS staffing the EXISTING spaces. There are many centres either closing or not running at capacity because they are unable to find qualified staff." – Langley Child Care Provider

- ★ **Cost of Facilities for Providers:** The cost to buy or lease child care spaces that meet provincial licensing and safety requirements is a barrier to space creation.
- ★ **Policy and Regulatory Framework:** Although the Township has a relatively permissive regulatory environment for child care, unintended barriers to the creation of more spaces may exist, and there appears to be opportunities to clarify the different roles of the Township and Fraser Health Authority.

"The biggest challenge is to find suitable space. When [approving] permits to build new townhouses and apartments, consider the childcare needs." – Langley Child Care Provider

"Consider easing zoning/bylaws in residential neighbourhoods" – Langley Child Care Provider

- ★ **Partnerships and Collaboration:** Existing community planning tables and liaison groups provide a solid foundation for coordination, but there are opportunities to strengthen partnerships and collaboration on child care.
- ★ **Data Monitoring:** The Township does not currently monitor data related to child care on a regular basis, including child care space data available from Fraser Health Authority.
- ★ **Anticipated Systems Change:** The Province of BC has committed to universal child care, but the details of this system and how the transition will unfold are unclear.

What We Heard From Local Businesses

Child care gaps in the Township affect more than children and families. Local business organizations said that the current child care situation is impacting the ability of many businesses to recruit and retain employees. Many business owners themselves have young children, and need better access to more affordable, flexible child care.

Action on child care is more than a strategy for social sustainability; it's also a strategy for economic sustainability.



Child Care Space Creation Targets

The child care space creation targets are the number of child care spaces required to adequately address the needs of families in the Township of Langley. The Township has identified coverage rate targets of 70% for children under the age of 3 and between the ages of 3 to 5, and 55% for children between the ages of 6 to 12. In other words, for children aged 5 and under, the target coverage is 70 spaces per 100 children, and for children aged 6 to 12, the target is 55 spaces per 100 children.⁸

Based on population projections for children in each age group to the year 2030, the following tables (3 to 5) outline the number of child care spaces needed to maintain the current 2020 coverage rates over the next 10 years and the number of child care spaces needed to reach the target coverage rates by 2030. The Township of Langley is not solely responsible for ensuring these targets are met – rather, collaboration and partnerships with the Province and local stakeholders can support the creation of additional child care spaces.

As shown in the following tables, a significant increase in spaces will be required to provide Township families with an adequate supply of child care to meet their needs.



⁸ The methodology used to determine space creation targets is informed by other child care studies, including the Surrey Child Care Gap Assessment (2011), the Comox Valley Child Care Plan (2019), and research completed by Statistics Canada. The results from stakeholder consultation and public engagement confirm that additional child care spaces are needed in the Township of Langley.

To reach the target coverage rate of 70% by the year 2030 for children under the age of 3, an average of 284 spaces would need to be created each year.

Table 3: Child Care Space Creation Targets, Children Under 3

					
Year	Number of Children	MAINTAIN Current 2020 Coverage Rate of 16.2%		REACH New Target Coverage Rate of 70% by 2030	
		TOTAL Spaces Required	Net New Spaces Required (Total - Existing)	TOTAL Spaces Required	Net New Spaces Required (Total - Existing)
2020	4,600	745	-	745	-
2021	4,601	745	0	1,364	619
2022	4,656	754	9	2,007	1,262
2025	4,820	781	36	2,726	1,981
2030	5,123	830	85 (8.5 spaces/year)	3,586	2,841 (284 spaces/year)

Source: 2016 Census (Township Community Level Custom Data, Age in Single Years Data), Township Building Permit Data, Metro Vancouver Population Projections, Fraser Health Authority

To reach the target coverage rate of 70% by the year 2030 for children between the ages of 3 to 5, an average of 148 spaces would need to be created each year.

Table 4: Child Care Space Creation Targets, Children Ages 3 to 5

 Children Age 3 To 5					
Year	Number of Children	MAINTAIN Current 2020 Coverage Rate of 48.7%		REACH New Target Coverage Rate of 70% by 2030	
		TOTAL Spaces Required	Net New Spaces Required (Total - Existing)	TOTAL Spaces Required	Net New Spaces Required (Total - Existing)
2020	4,271	2,079	-	2,079	-
2021	4,401	2,143	64	2,378	299
2022	4,626	2,253	174	2,746	667
2025	4,774	2,325	246	3,008	1,009
2030	5,082	2,475	396 (40 spaces/year)	3,557	1,478 (148 spaces/year)

Source: 2016 Census (Township Community Level Custom Data, Age in Single Years Data), Township Building Permit Data, Metro Vancouver Population Projections, Fraser Health Authority

To reach the target coverage rate of 55% by the year 2030, an average of 575 spaces would need to be created each year.

Table 5: Child Care Space Creation Targets, Children Ages 6 to 12

 Children Age 6 To 12					
Year	Number of Children	MAINTAIN Current 2020 Coverage Rate of 10.2%		REACH New Target Coverage Rate of 55% by 2030	
		TOTAL Spaces Required	Net New Spaces Required (Total - Existing)	TOTAL Spaces Required	Net New Spaces Required (Total - Existing)
2020	11,113	1,130	-	1,130	-
2021	11,095	1,132	2	2,374	1,244
2022	11,040	1,126	(4)	3,599	2,469
2025	11,445	1,167	37	5,013	3,883
2030	12,500	1,275	144 (14 spaces/year)	6,875	5,745 (575 spaces/year)

Source: 2016 Census (Township Community Level Custom Data, Age in Single Years Data), Township Building Permit Data, Metro Vancouver Population Projections, Fraser Health Authority

Based on the Needs Assessment, it is estimated that approximately 5% to 10% of the new spaces created over the next ten years should provide flexible care (i.e. child care outside of regular business hours).

Overall, approximately 10,000 new spaces will be required to support a universally accessible child care system by 2030, an average of 1,000 new spaces per year. For comparison, between 2015 and 2020, an average of about 100 new spaces were developed in the Township per year.

Action Plan

The Action Plan consists of a 10-year vision and five 5-year priorities with associated actions. It provides a roadmap for the Township to support space creation, address related challenges, and harness emerging opportunities, in collaboration with community partners.

The Implementation section outlines the timelines and potential partners for the actions.

Vision

A vision is meant to inspire and give direction, providing a motivating stretch goal to work towards. Our 10-year child care vision is:

Affordable, accessible, and quality child care that meets the diverse needs of all Township children and families.

- ▶ Affordable care means care that is attainable for all Township families.
- ▶ Accessible care means the right kind of care in the right place.
- ▶ Quality care means a safe and healthy environment for children to thrive.
- ▶ Care that meets the diverse needs of all means Township children and families receive the care and support they need based on their individual circumstances and context.

Priorities and Actions

Five 5-year priorities are established to advance the Township towards its child care vision:

1. Increase the number of licensed spaces;
2. Improve child care affordability;
3. Strengthen partnerships and collaboration;
4. Address staffing challenges; and,
5. Enhance before- and after-school programming.

Within each priority area there are concrete actions for the Township to undertake over the next five years. These actions aim to build on existing community assets and reflect the Township's role as a local government.

PRIORITY 1: INCREASE THE NUMBER OF LICENSED CHILD CARE SPACES

Township families currently do not have sufficient access to child care. While coverage rates reflect a lack of child care for all age groups, there is a greater need for infant/toddler care, and school-aged care.

In order to increase the number of quality, licensed child care spaces, a comprehensive approach is recommended, inclusive of multiple elements: policy and regulatory updates, consideration of available funding opportunities, and additional guidance around the location of new child care facilities.

ACTIONS

- A. **Develop location criteria to help guide decision-making and ensure child care is developed in suitable and priority locations (e.g. adjacent to schools and near transit).**
- B. **Review the Township's Official Community Plan (OCP) with a view of seeking opportunities to strengthen child care policies, removing unintended barriers to space creation, and reducing possible inconsistencies across communities and neighbourhoods.**

For Example: New Westminster OCP

New Westminster's recently updated OCP contains a strong social policy framework, specifically regarding child care. Child care is referenced in Section 1 of the Plan:

- ★ *Facilitate the development of an adequate number of high-quality, accessible and affordable child care spaces that meet the needs of residents and workers (Policy 1.9).*

Policy 1.9 contains sub-policies which provide further specific direction:

- ★ Consider incorporating child care facilities in civic projects, and encourage private development projects to include child care.
- ★ Implement the Child Care Strategy.
- ★ Develop five Child Development Hubs with New Westminster Public Partners Child Development Committee.
- ★ Co-ordinate with senior levels of government to plan and fund a comprehensive child care system.

- C. **Review the Zoning Bylaw for unintended barriers to the development of additional child care.**

- D. Create a short guide for prospective operators that clearly articulates zoning, business licensing, child care licensing, and other pertinent requirements and processes.

For Example: Child Care Facility Requirements Brochure

The City of Coquitlam created a brochure that outlines the rules that apply to child care facilities in Coquitlam.

This brochure includes information related to general regulations, building permit requirements, application requirements, inspections, and business licensing.



- E. Assess existing municipal facilities that could be retrofitted with child care spaces and consider including child care spaces in any new facilities, with support from available provincial capital funding, and look to prioritize leases to providers that address the needs of underserved groups and provide flexible care.
- F. Explore strategies to transform spaces that may be underused in the Township into child care facilities (e.g. schools, religious assembly spaces, and amenity spaces in strata developments).

Co-location is increasingly recognized as a best practice in the realm of social services. Elementary schools and child care centres are inherently compatible land uses, and responses from the parent survey indicate there is significant support for child care located close to elementary schools.



As part of the redevelopment of Lord Nelson Elementary School in Vancouver, a child care facility was constructed on the roof.



- G. Complete additional research on municipal best practices for providing more direct support for child care (e.g. space or funding support through community amenity contributions).
- H. Explore the feasibility of the Township delivering licensed child care.



For Example: Delta's Awesome Afterschool Program

Awesome Afterschool is a licensed before- and after-school program offered at South Delta Recreation Centre and Pinewood Leisure Centre. It is available to students from kindergarten to grade six. The program promotes an active lifestyle for kids, providing time in the gym/halls for fun activities. Pick up and drop off is offered for several elementary schools.

The program is offered Monday – Friday; before-school care runs from 7:00 – 9:00am, after-school care runs from 3:00 – 6:00pm.

PRIORITY 2: IMPROVE CHILD CARE AFFORDABILITY

Child care is too expensive for many families, and for some, the cost prevents them from accessing care. These actions outline an approach to address child care affordability that is based on advocacy and education.

ACTIONS

- A. Advocate to the Ministry of Children and Family Development (MCFD) to establish \$10/day prototype sites in the Township of Langley.**
- B. Include links on the Township website to information on provincial funding that lowers child care fees for families.**

What are \$10/day prototype sites?

Prototype sites are child care facilities that receive operating funding from the Province to offer low-cost quality child care in communities. The sites are being introduced to test funding models and operational supports required to move BC towards a universal child care system.

PRIORITY 3: STRENGTHEN PARTNERSHIPS AND COLLABORATION

The Township of Langley is well-positioned to facilitate partnerships among key stakeholders to encourage the development of child care facilities. This priority guides the Township to strengthen partnerships with other government agencies, community organizations, and local businesses to address child care issues.

ACTIONS

- A. Continue Township staff participation on the Langley Children Committee to monitor child care trends and work collaboratively on solutions.**
- B. Seek and implement opportunities to discuss child care at Langley Healthier Community Partnership steering committee meetings more regularly, to promote enhanced information sharing and collaborative action.**
- C. Create a child care working group composed of Township staff, and convene meetings on a regular basis to discuss community issues and initiatives.**
- D. Explore and implement opportunities to strengthen collaboration with Langley School District No. 35 on child care.**

For Example: Burnaby School District and City of Burnaby Child Care Facilities Memorandum of Agreement

Under this agreement, negotiated in October 2014, up to 12 child care centres could be built on school sites throughout the community. Using community amenity contributions levied from development, the City would be responsible for the capital costs of developing the centres, the School District would provide the land, and locally-based non-profit organizations would operate the centres.

The City and School District are currently working to install modular child care facilities on the first two school sites: Capital Hill Children's Centre (25 spaces for 3 to 5 year old children) and Montecito Children's Centre (25 spaces for 3 to 5 year old children).

- E. Enhance communication with providers to monitor trends and emerging issues.**

PRIORITY 4: ADDRESS STAFFING CHALLENGES

Many local child care providers struggle to recruit and retain qualified staff, which makes it difficult to keep existing spaces and make child care more available. The actions outlined below focus on convening government agencies, community organizations, and other stakeholders to develop local solutions that address staffing challenges and support related provincial initiatives.

ACTIONS

- A. **Initiate discussions with local post-secondary institutions and other stakeholders regarding the establishment of an early childhood education (ECE) program in Langley.**
- B. **Convene stakeholders for a social innovation lab to develop and prototype local solutions that address staffing challenges, including recruitment and retention.**

What is a Social Innovation Lab?

Innovation Labs are intended to support **multi-stakeholder groups** in addressing a **complex social problem**.

"Social Innovation Labs emphasize not only imagining high potential interventions but also gaining system sight, redefining problems, and identifying opportunities in the broader context with the potential to tip systems in positive directions. It is a three-step process of developing, testing and instigating innovation strategies."

-Social Innovation Lab Guide, Rockefeller Foundation

- C. **Explore opportunities to support and communicate initiatives under the Province's Early Care and Learning Recruitment and Retention Strategy and advocate for further advancement in this area.**

Provincial Early Care and Learning Recruitment and Retention Strategy

As part of the Childcare BC Plan, the BC Government is investing \$136 million, supplemented by another \$16.3 million in federal dollars, over three years to enhance the quality of child care, including substantial investments in the child care workforce through the Recruitment and Retention Strategy.

The strategy is focused on compensation, education and training, professional development and quality:

- ▶ Front-line early childhood educators working in licensed child care facilities that have opted in to the Child Care Fee Reduction Initiative may be eligible to receive a \$2 per hour wage enhancement.
- ▶ The Ministry of Advanced Education, Skills and Training is investing \$7.4 million over three years to expand existing ECE programs across public post-secondary institutions. This is expected to help an additional 620 ECEs graduate over the next three years.
- ▶ To help students access ECE education, the Ministry of Children and Family Development (MCFD) is enhancing and expanding the Early Childhood Educators of BC ECE Education Fund through two funding streams:
 - ▶ ECE Bursary Program: Funding of up to \$500 per course to help with tuition, books and materials.
 - ▶ ECE Workforce Development Fund: Funding of up to \$5,000 per semester to help existing child care staff with ancillary costs associated with continuing education.
- ▶ MCFD is creating a professional development fund to expand opportunities for ECEs to complete ongoing professional development and stay current on emerging research, trends and practices in the early learning sector.
- ▶ The Community Early Childhood Facilitators Program - which provides a platform for ECEs to connect and share learnings - has been piloting a project in three BC communities. The provincial government will work with the early Childhood Pedagogy Network to expand this pilot program across the province.
- ▶ The provincial government is working with the child care sector to develop ECE Standards of Practice and recently updated BC's Early Learning Framework.

PRIORITY 5: ENHANCE BEFORE- AND AFTER-SCHOOL RECREATION PROGRAMMING

Many parents and guardians rely on recreation programming as a means of child care for school age children, given the limited availability of licensed child care. The Township's Active Beyond the Bell after-school recreation program runs for two hours after school in select elementary school gymnasiums and recreation centres. Although Active Beyond the Bell is not a licensed child care program and is currently limited by provincial regulations to a maximum of two hours, this program plays an important role in after-school child minding. These actions recognize the importance of recreation in filling child care gaps with fun programs that promote physical activity and healthy living.

ACTIONS

- A. Seek opportunities to enhance and expand the Active Beyond the Bell program to additional school locations, with a focus on those without sufficient after-school care.
- B. Explore piloting a before-school recreational program, possibly in partnership with another local organization.
- C. Advocate the Province for amendments to child care regulations that would allow for longer before- and after-school recreation programming.

For Example: Ontario's Before-and-After School Programs

In Ontario, school boards are required to offer before-and-after school programs (for children 4 to 12 years old) where there is sufficient demand from parents and families.

Ontario's After School Program provides funding to help sport and recreation organizations deliver quality programs for children and youth in priority neighbourhoods. The programs generally run between 3:00 p.m. – 6:00 p.m. and aim to help children and youth get active, develop healthy eating habits, and gain confidence and do better in school.



Implementation

A high-level implementation timeline is outlined below. Recognizing there may be changes to the child care situation as the Province continues to work towards a universal system, the Township will re-evaluate the merits of each action before proceeding with implementation. For the same reason, the Township will review and, as required, update the priorities after five years, and develop a new set of recommended actions.

ONGOING + SHORT TERM ACTIONS (1-2 YEARS)

Reference Number	Action
1A.	Develop location criteria to help guide decision-making and ensure child care is developed in suitable and priority locations (e.g. adjacent to schools and near transit).
1D.	Create a short guide for prospective operators that clearly articulates zoning, business licensing, child care licensing, and other pertinent requirements and processes.
1E.	Assess existing municipal facilities that could be retrofitted with child care spaces and consider including child care spaces in any new facilities, with support from available provincial capital funding, and look to prioritize leases to providers that address the needs of underserved groups and provide flexible care.
2A.	Advocate to the Ministry of Children and Family Development (MCFD) to establish \$10/day prototype sites in the Township of Langley.
2B.	Include links on the Township website to information on provincial funding that lowers child care fees for families.
3A.	Continue Township staff participation on the Langley Children Committee to monitor child care trends and work collaboratively on solutions.
3B.	Seek and implement opportunities to discuss child care at Langley Healthier Community Partnership steering committee meetings more regularly, to promote enhanced information sharing and collaborative action.
3C.	Create a child care working group composed of Township staff, and convene meetings on a regular basis to discuss community issues and initiatives.
3D.	Explore and implement opportunities to strengthen collaboration with Langley School District No. 35 on child care.
3E.	Enhance communication with providers to monitor trends and emerging issues.

Reference Number	Action
4A.	Initiate discussions with local post-secondary institutions and other stakeholders regarding the establishment of an early childhood education (ECE) program in Langley.
4C.	Explore opportunities to support and communicate initiatives under the Province's Early Care and Learning Recruitment and Retention Strategy and advocate for further advancement in this area.
5A.	Seek opportunities to enhance and expand the Active Beyond the Bell program to additional school locations, with a focus on those without sufficient after-school care.
5C.	Advocate the Province for amendments to child care regulations that would allow for longer before- and after-school recreation programming.

MEDIUM TERM ACTIONS (3-5 YEARS)

Reference Number	Proposed Action
1B.	Review the Township's OCP with a view of seeking opportunities to strengthen child care policies, removing unintended barriers to space creation, and reducing possible inconsistencies across communities and neighbourhoods.
1C.	Review the Zoning Bylaw for unintended barriers to the development of additional child care.
1F.	Explore strategies to transform spaces that may be underused in the Township into child care facilities (e.g. schools, religious assembly spaces, and amenity spaces in strata developments).
1G.	Complete additional research on municipal best practices for providing more direct support for child care (e.g. space or funding support through community amenity contributions).
1H.	Explore the feasibility of the Township delivering licensed child care.
4B.	Convene stakeholders for a social innovation lab to develop and prototype local solutions that address staffing challenges, including recruitment and retention.
5B.	Explore piloting a before-school recreational program, possibly in partnership with another local organization.

Potential Partners

The Township will look to collaborate with the following organizations and groups, among others, in implementing the actions:

- ★ The Province of BC
- ★ Langley City
- ★ Fraser Health Authority
- ★ School District No. 35
- ★ The Langley Children Committee
- ★ The Langley Child Care Resource and Referral Centre
- ★ Local child care providers
- ★ Local post-secondary institutions
- ★ Local business organizations
- ★ Community-based service providers

The Township and Langley City collaborated as part of the development of its Child Care Action Plans, with Langley City completing its Plan in June 2020. As a number of actions in the City's Plan are consistent with actions in this Plan, there will likely be opportunities for ongoing collaboration through implementation.



Monitoring and Reporting

IMPLEMENTATION PROGRESS

Implementation progress will be monitored annually in conjunction with the development of departmental work plans. A full progress report will be prepared in 2025 to inform the review of the priorities and the development of new actions.

MEASURING SUCCESS

To track progress towards the space creation targets, the Township will work to establish a data-sharing arrangement with Fraser Health Authority to receive child care space inventory data on a quarterly basis. An annual summary report on the number of child care spaces created will be made publicly available.

To track progress towards the 10-year vision and 5-year priorities, the Township will further engage stakeholders to identify key performance indicators and possible data sources. For the vision, these indicators could include:

- ★ Coverage rates
- ★ Waitlist data
- ★ Child care costs relative to income
- ★ Parent and guardian feedback on child care affordability
- ★ Parent and guardian feedback on child care quality
- ★ Number of spaces available with flexible hours
- ★ Number of spaces available for children needing extra support

For the priorities, these indicators could include:

- ★ Number of spaces created
- ★ Child care fees
- ★ Stakeholder feedback on community collaboration
- ★ Provider feedback on staffing issues
- ★ Number of before- and after-school recreation programs

Conclusion

Child care is an important part of a complete and sustainable community, providing economic and social benefits. The Child Care Action Plan envisions an affordable, accessible, and quality child care system that meets the diverse needs of all Township children and families. To work towards this vision, the Action Plan sets ambitious space creation targets and lays the foundation for Township action over the next five years. The Township, however, cannot do this work alone - realizing the vision will require bold action from other levels of government and enhanced collaboration across the public, private, and non-profit sectors.



Appendix A: Needs Assessment

Introduction

The Needs Assessment provides a detailed overview of the current child care situation, including supply and demand considerations. It also provides an overview of the key strengths, gaps, and trends that emerged from the research and community engagement. A complete summary of the community engagement activities and results is included in the Phase One Community Engagement Report.

Child Care and Early Childhood Development

Affordable, accessible, quality child care is important for early childhood development. The Human Early Learning Partnership (HELP), based out of the University of British Columbia (UBC), brings together researchers and practitioners to address complex child development issues. Through their work, they have created the Early Development Instrument (EDI), a 104-item questionnaire designed to measure early childhood development and vulnerability. This information is collected on a three-year schedule called a “Wave” to capture sufficient data in all school districts in the province. The EDI is completed for individual kindergarten students by their teachers once the children enter the public school system and measures physical health and well-being, social competence, emotional maturity, language and cognitive development, communication skills, and general knowledge. The “**vulnerability rate**” is based on the number of students starting school with vulnerabilities in one or more areas critical to their healthy development.

The Langley Community Profile explores EDI data for Langley School District No. 35 (SD35) and its neighbourhoods. It provides an overview of the patterns and trends in early child development for Wave 7 (2016–2019) and explores change over time.

★ **In the Township, the vulnerability rate is currently 30%, which is lower than the rate observed across BC (33%).** However, in particular areas, the vulnerability rate is higher than the provincial average, as indicated in Table 1.

LANGLEY (SD 35) WAVE 7

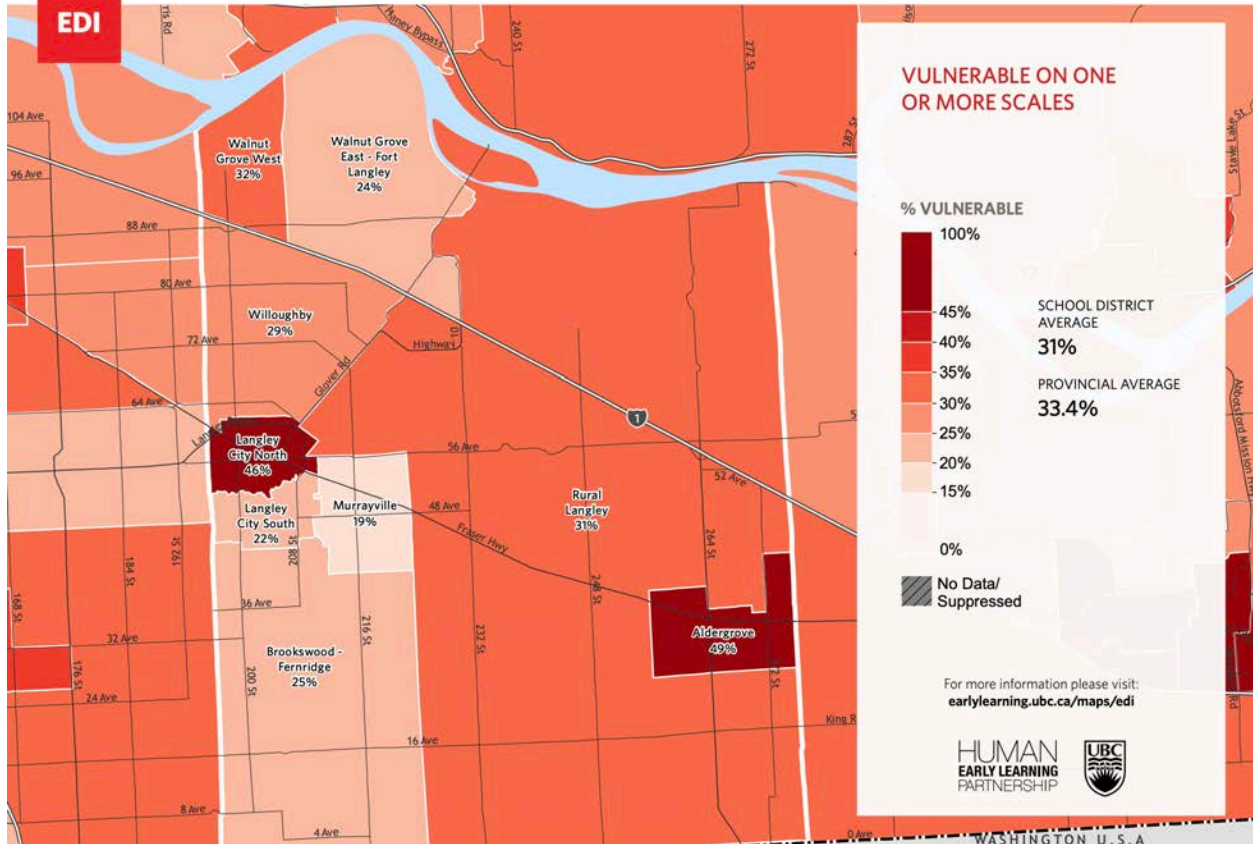


Table 1: EDI Rates, Township of Langley, Wave 2 and 7

Geographic Area	Wave 2		Wave 7	
	Number of Children Vulnerable	Percentage of Children Vulnerable	Number of Children Vulnerable	Percentage of Children Vulnerable
Aldergrove	45	31%	63	49%
Brookwood-Fernridge	22	15%	30	25%
Murrayville	22	15%	15	19%
Rural	40	24%	53	31%
Walnut Grove East - Fort Langley	29	14%	33	24%
Walnut Grove West	9	14%	29	32%
Willoughby	41	35%	131	29%
Township of Langley	210	21%	354	30%

Source: Human Early Learning Partnership. Early Development Instrument [EDI] report. Wave 7 Community Profile, 2019. Langley School District (SD35). Vancouver, BC: University of British Columbia, Faculty of Medicine, School of Population and Public Health; February 2020. Available from: http://earlylearning.ubc.ca/media/edi_w7_communityprofiles/edi_w7_communityprofile_sd_35.pdf

The EDI summary report emphasizes neighbourhood differences can be explained by a wide range of factors, including social and economic differences, variations in community networks and collaborations that support children and families, and also the number, quality, and accessibility of programs. Thus, there is likely a need for improved access to quality programming in neighbourhoods with higher early childhood vulnerability.

Current Child Care Situation

Supply Considerations

CURRENT CHILD CARE COVERAGE RATES

As of January 2020, there were a total of 3,954 licensed child care spaces in the Township of Langley, delivered through 197 child care programs. The number of child care spaces was determined based on information provided by the Fraser Health Authority. The number of children was estimated based on 2016 Census information (Township Community Level Custom Data and Age in Single Years Data) and Township Building Permit Data. Table 2 provides a summary of child care spaces⁹, and the number of children to determine child care coverage rates. Licensed preschool spaces are included within the total number of child care spaces.

As shown in Table 2, the Township's child care coverage rate for children aged 12 and under is 19.8 spaces per 100 children. It is noted that the coverage rate in Langley City is 26.0 spaces per 100 children, resulting in a combined coverage rate of 20.7 spaces for 100 children in the Langleys. As per the data, the coverage rate is lowest for school aged children. This information is analyzed on a community level basis (as seen in the maps and tables below), but it is important to note that for the entirety of the Township, the need for school-aged care (6-12 years) and infant/toddler care (under 3 years) is significant.

Table 2: Child Care Coverage Rates, Township of Langley, 2020

Township of Langley			
Age Group	Children	Child Care Spaces	Child Care Spaces Per 100 Children
Under 3 years	4,600	745	16.2
3 - 5 years	4,271	2,079	48.7
6 - 12 years	11,113	1,130	10.2
0 - 12 years	19,984	3,954	19.8

Source: 2016 Census (Township Community Level Custom Data, Age in Single Years Data), Township Building Permit Data, Fraser Health Authority

⁹ Family child care spaces, multi-age child care spaces, and in-home multi age child care spaces were evenly split between the under 3 age group, the 3 to 5 age group and the 6 to 12 age group as children in these facilities may be between 0 to 12 years of age.

Table 3 presents child care coverage rates for children between the ages of 0 to 12, in each of the Township's communities. This table demonstrates that Aldergrove, Brookswood-Fernridge, Walnut Grove, and Rural have lower coverage rates than the Township average (19.8 spaces for 100 children between the ages of 0 to 12). That said, due to its relatively large population of children, Willoughby may have the highest number of children unserved, with over 7,000 children aged 12 and under and less than 2,000 licensed child care spaces.

For the Rural community, findings from public engagement demonstrate parents would like child care located close to their homes or their child(ren)'s elementary school. It could be assumed that some parents living in rural areas are able to meet their child care needs through services offered in the Township's urban areas. However, it is still important to recognize additional child care is needed in rural areas to meet the needs of parents who do not travel to urban areas for work.

Simultaneously, further discussion regarding the location of child care highlights the necessity to locate child care in areas well-served by transit, to ensure staff and parents can easily access the facility. These considerations are important to understand prior to the development of new child care centres in the Township of Langley.

Table 3: Child Care Coverage Rates, Community-Level Analysis, Children 0 to 12, 2020

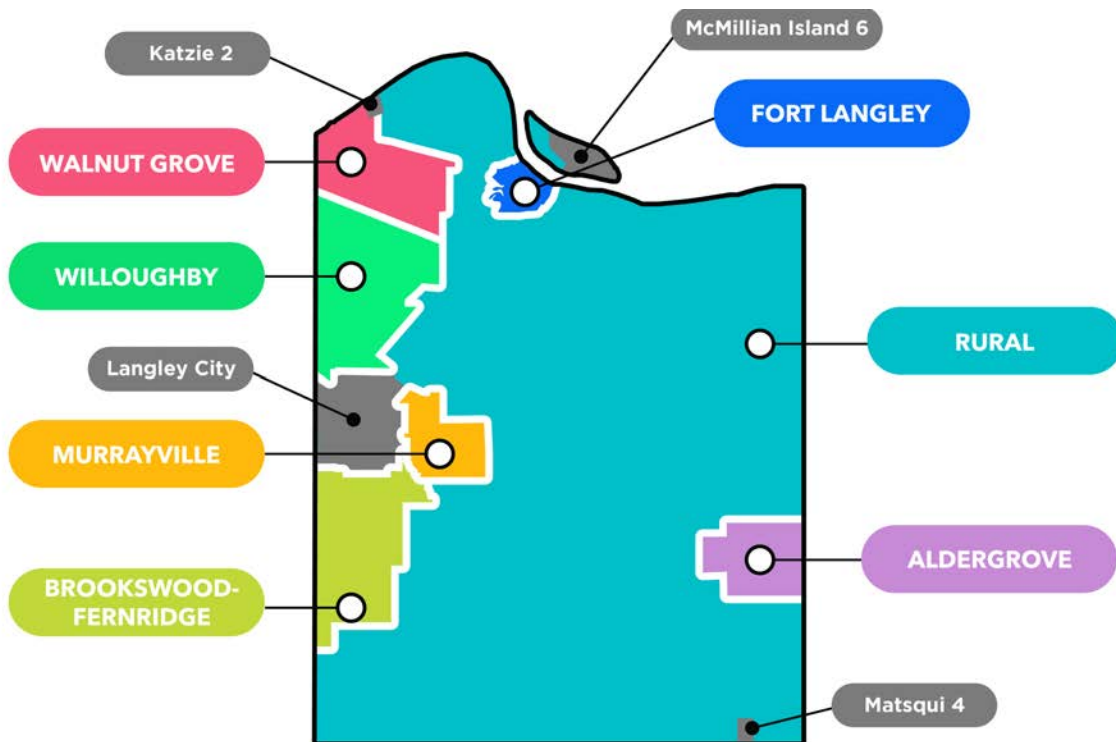
Township of Langley Community	Children Aged 0-12	Child Care Spaces	Child Care Spaces Per 100 Children
Aldergrove	2,179	331	15.2
Brookswood-Fernridge	1,819	253	13.9
Fort Langley	476	165	34.7
Murrayville	1,323	286	21.6
Walnut Grove	3,954	770	19.5
Willoughby	7,282	1,903	26.1
Rural	2,951	246	8.3

Source: 2016 Census (Township Community Level Custom Data, Age in Single Years Data), Township Building Permit Data, Fraser Health Authority

Table 4 presents child care coverage rates for children under the age of 3 in Township communities, which illustrates the differences in coverage rates across the Township, some of which are quite significant.

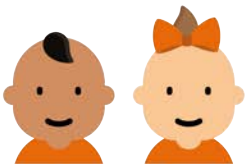
For instance, Fort Langley has no spaces for children under the age of 3, and the coverage rates in the Rural community and Brookwood-Fernridge are very low (3.1, and 5.8, respectively). Willoughby has the most children and the most child care spaces – when this community is excluded from analysis, the coverage rate for children under the age of 3 is only 10 spaces for every 100 children. This is of particular cause for concern, as many parents and guardians require infant/toddler care.

TOWNSHIP OF LANGLEY COMMUNITIES



Areas in grey are jurisdictions outside of the Township

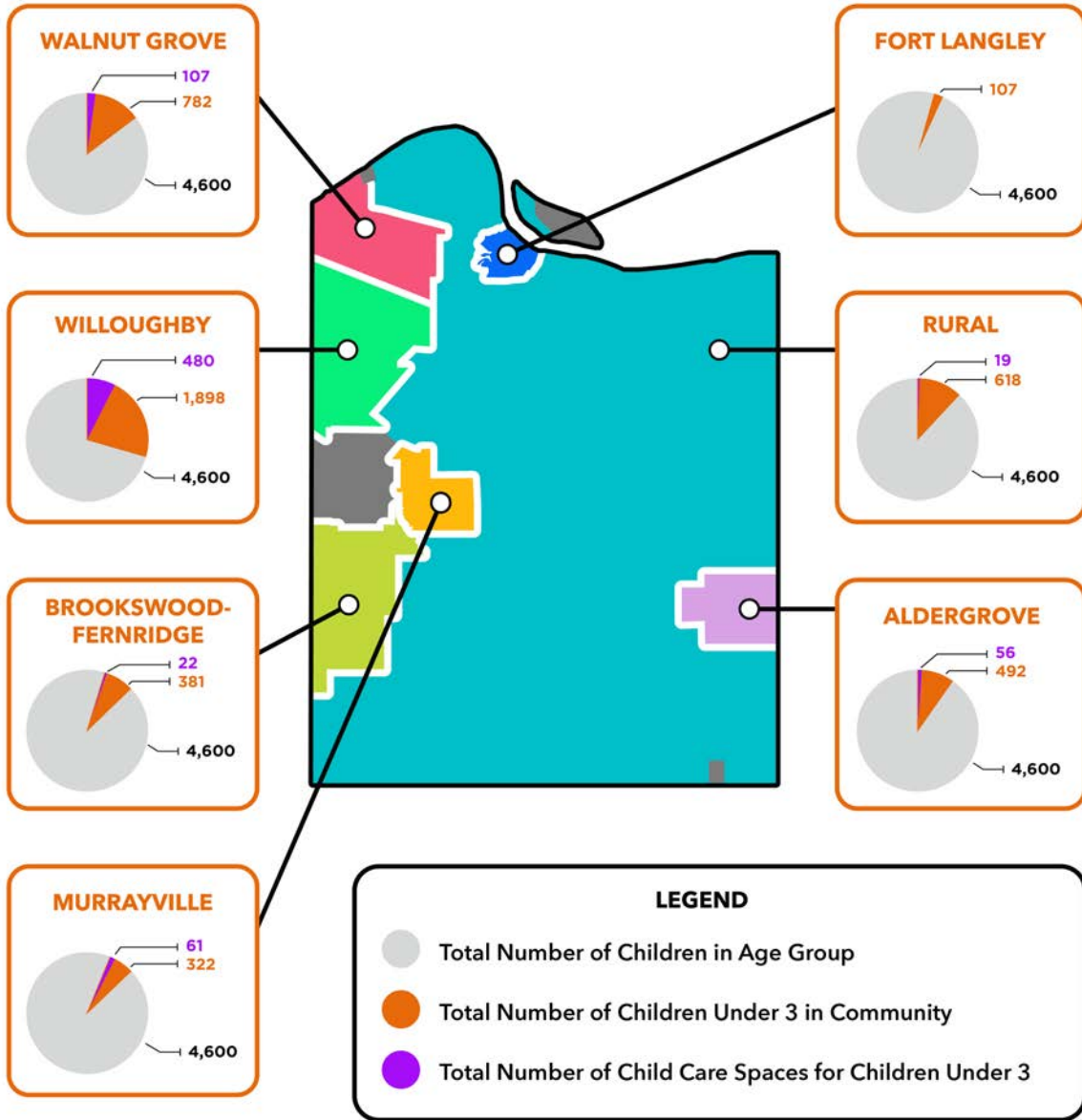
Table 4: Child Care Coverage Rates, Community-Level Analysis, Children Under 3, 2020

 Children Under 3			
Township of Langley Community	Children	Child Care Spaces	Child Care Spaces Per 100 Children
Aldergrove	492	56	11.4
Brookwood-Fernridge	381	22	5.8
Fort Langley	107	0	0
Murrayville	322	61	18.9
Walnut Grove	782	107	13.7
Willoughby	1,898	480	25.3
Rural	618	19	3.1

Source: 2016 Census (Township Community Level Custom Data, Age in Single Years Data), Township Building Permit Data, Fraser Health Authority



Children Under 3



Areas in grey are jurisdictions outside of the Township

Table 5 identifies the importance of assessing child care availability for particular age groups, as the overall 19.8 coverage rate does not indicate the extent to which care is needed for each age group. While there is more care available for children 3 to 5 years of age, parent/guardian survey results demonstrate 23% of respondents do not have child care at the times or days required, and 68% of respondents disagree or strongly disagree that there is an adequate supply of all forms of child care services in Langley. It is also important to note that the total number of licensed child care spaces for children age 3 to 5 includes part-time preschool spaces.

Furthermore, the community level analysis illustrates important nuances in the provision of care. For children ages 3 to 5, Fort Langley has the highest coverage rate, at 82.5 spaces per 100 children. The Rural community and Brookwood-Fernridge have the lowest coverage rates, at 26.4 and 30.4, respectively.

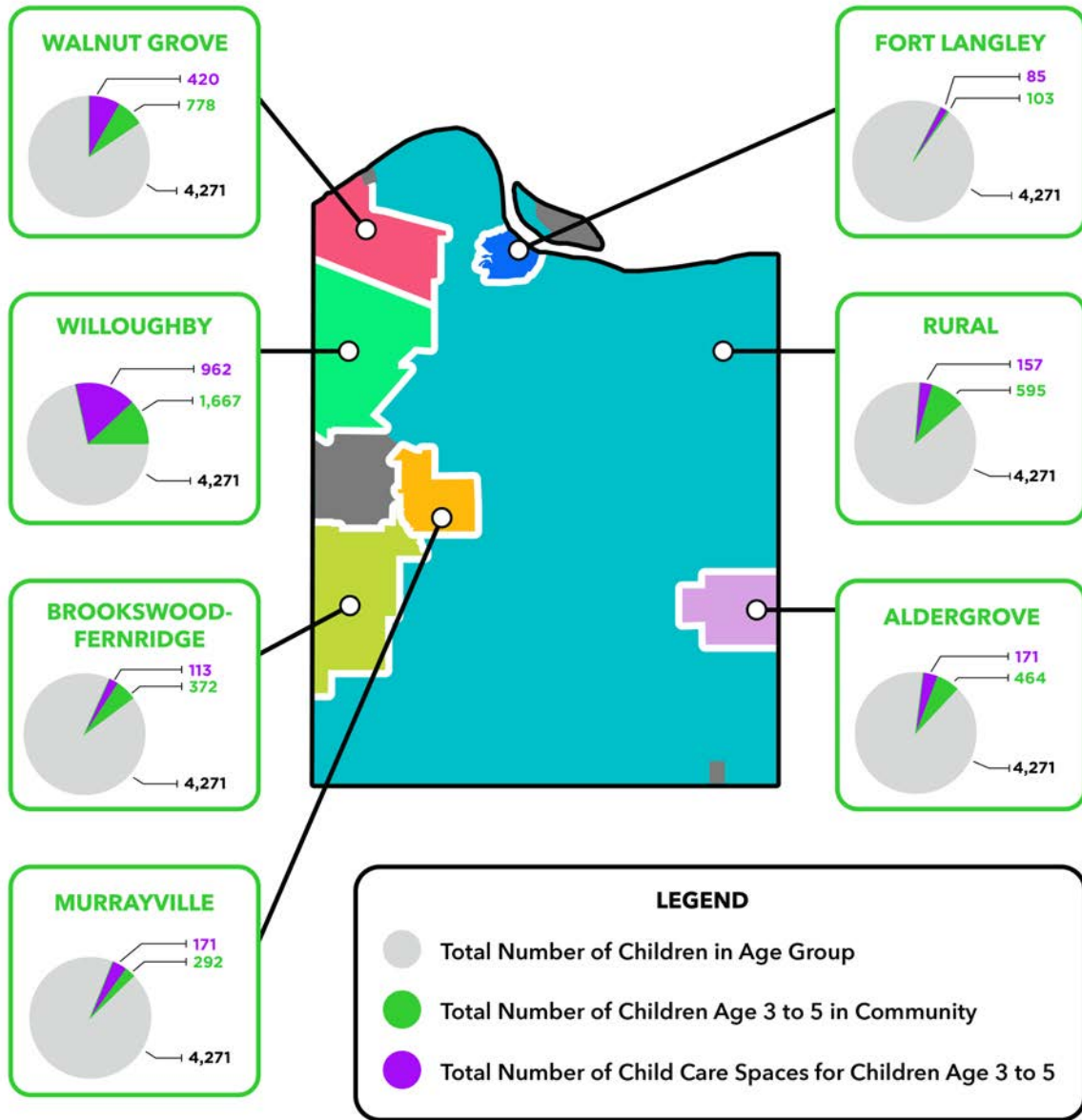
Table 5: Child Care Coverage Rate, Community-Level Analysis, Children Ages 3 to 5, 2020

 Children Age 3 To 5			
Township of Langley Community	Children	Child Care Spaces	Child Care Spaces Per 100 Children
Aldergrove	464	171	36.9
Brookwood-Fernridge	372	113	30.4
Fort Langley	103	85	82.5
Murrayville	292	171	58.8
Walnut Grove	778	420	54.0
Willoughby	1,667	962	57.7
Rural	595	157	26.4

Source: 2016 Census (Township Community Level Custom Data, Age in Single Years Data), Township Building Permit Data, Fraser Health Authority



Children Age 3 To 5

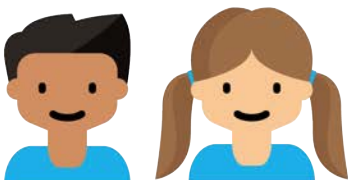


Areas in grey are jurisdictions outside of the Township

Child care coverage rates for children ages 6 to 12 (Table 6) are much lower than the rates identified for children ages 3 to 5, and while the need for care generally decreases with age, the limited availability of spaces for older children is significant and is reflected in results from community consultation. 62% of parents and guardians are looking for child care that is school age, out-of-school care.

The community level analysis indicates the need for school-aged care is especially prevalent in certain communities, such as Rural areas (4.0 coverage rate), Murrayville (7.8 coverage rate), and Aldergrove (8.4 coverage rate). This analysis indicates child care coverage rates yield useful information when sorted by age of children and location of care.

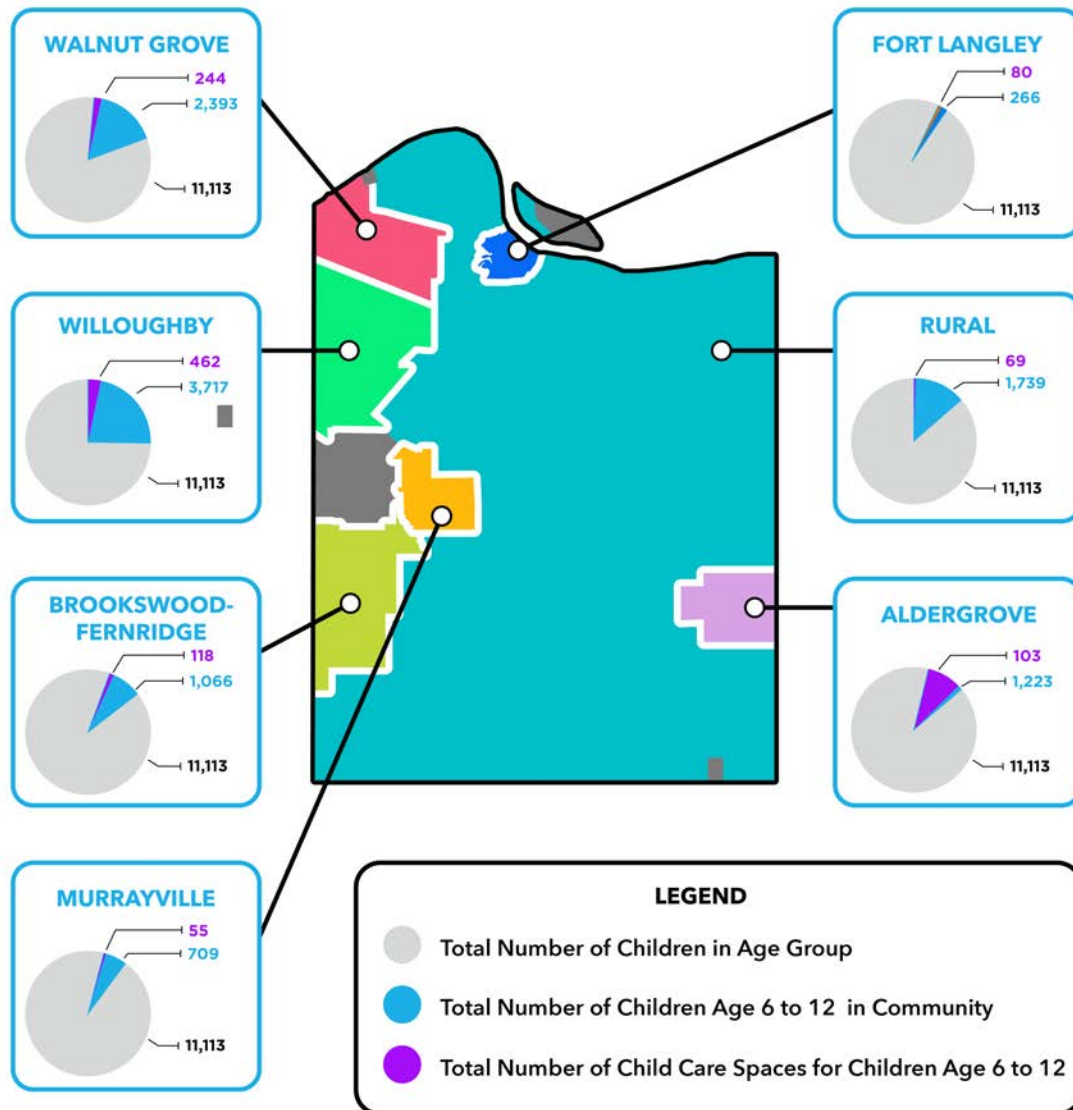
Table 6: Child Care Coverage Rate, Community-Level Analysis, Children Ages 6 to 12, 2020

 Children Age 6 To 12			
Township of Langley Community	Children	Child Care Spaces	Child Care Spaces Per 100 Children
Aldergrove	1,223	103	8.4
Brookwood-Fernridge	1,066	118	11.1
Fort Langley	266	80	30.1
Murrayville	709	55	7.8
Walnut Grove	2,393	244	10.2
Willoughby	3,717	462	12.4
Rural	1,739	69	4.0

Source: 2016 Census (Township Community Level Custom Data, Age in Single Years Data), Township Building Permit Data, Fraser Health Authority



Children Age 6 To 12



Areas in grey are jurisdictions outside of the Township

In order to understand how the availability of child care in the Township of Langley compares to other jurisdictions, a literature review was completed. The information collected through this analysis helps to demonstrate the extent to which additional child care spaces are needed in the Township of Langley.

- ★ In 2019, Metro Vancouver completed a municipal inventory of child care spaces and found that, on average, there are 18.6 child care spaces per 100 children age 12 and under in Metro Vancouver.¹⁰ The number of spaces varies across the region, with the highest ratios in Tsawwassen First Nation (at over 101.8 spaces per 100 children) and UBC (42.3 spaces per 100 children), and the lowest ratios in Surrey (12.7 spaces per 100 children), and Belcarra (0 spaces per 100 children).
- ★ The Metro Vancouver inventory further specifies a provincial average of 18.4 spaces per 100 children, 0 to 12 years of age, and a national average of 27.2 spaces per 100 children, 0 to 12 years of age.
- ★ In 2018, the Canadian Centre for Policy Alternatives (CCPA) published a report titled *Child Care Deserts in Canada*, which attempts to map a complete list of licensed child care spaces across the country against the number of children¹¹ in a given postal code. The report defines child care deserts as postal codes with more than 50 non-school-aged children but less than one licensed child care spot for every three children (a coverage rate of under 33%). The report specifies that licensed child care coverage is highest in Charlottetown, Prince Edward Island, and many of the bigger cities in Quebec. These cities have an average coverage rate of 70% or better, meaning there are at least seven spaces for every 10 children not yet in school. Metro Vancouver does not fare as well, with a very low coverage rate of 35%, meaning there are three non-school aged children for every licensed space. BC has a coverage rate of 37% for non-school aged children.

¹⁰ 2019 Survey of Licensed Child Care Spaces and Policies in Metro Vancouver, August 2019, http://www.metrovancouver.org/services/regional-planning/PlanningPublications/2019_Survey_of_Licensed_Child_Care_Spaces_Policies_Metro_Vancouver.pdf

¹¹ This study focuses on non-school-aged children between the ages of 0 to 4.

Demand Considerations

CURRENT POPULATION

Census data reveals that population growth in the Township of Langley averaged 2.5% per year from 2006 to 2016. This represents a population increase of 2,356 people per year. Growth was slightly faster between 2011 and 2016 (averaging 2.5% or 2,622 people per year) compared to between 2006 and 2011 (averaging 2.2 % or 2,090 people per year). The number of children has also been growing, most significantly in the 0 to 2 age group.

Using building permit data since 2016, the 2020 population for children aged 0 to 12 is estimated to be 19,984.

Table 7: Population Growth, Township of Langley, 2006 to 2016

Township of Langley	2006	2011	2016	Average Annual Growth Rate, 2006-2016	Average Annual Change, 2006-2016
Total Population	93,726	104,177	117,285	2.5%	2,356
Children Aged 0-2	3,005	3,495	3,895	3.0%	89
Children Aged 3-5	3,240	3,655	4,190	2.9%	95
Children Aged 6-12	8,925	9,335	10,515	1.8%	159
Total Children Aged 0-12	15,170	16,485	18,600	2.3%	343

Source: Statistics Canada, Census (2006, 2011, 2016)

ANTICIPATED POPULATION

According to the Metro Vancouver Regional District's current population projections for the Township of Langley:

- ★ The population in the Township **aged 0 to 2 is expected to grow by 523 children between 2020 and 2030, an increase of 11.4% over the projected 10-year period.** At an annual projected growth rate of 1.1%, this increase is less than the historical growth rates over the previous 10 years (3.0%).

- ★ The population in the Township of Langley **aged 3 to 5 is expected to grow by 811 children between 2020 and 2030, an increase of 19% over the projected 10-year period.** At an annual growth rate of 1.9%, this increase is less than the historical annual growth rate over the previous 10 years (2.9%).
- ★ Lastly, the population in the Township of Langley **aged 6 to 12 is expected to grow by 1,387 children between 2020 and 2030, an increase of 12.5% over the projected 10-year period.** At an annual growth rate of 1.2%, this increase is slightly less than the historical growth rates over the previous 10 years (1.8%).

Table 8: Projected Population Growth, Township of Langley, 2020 to 2030

Township of Langley	2020	2022	2025	2030	Average Annual Growth Rate, 2020-2030	Average Annual Change, 2020-2030
Total Population	134,747	139,520	148,417	162,933	2.1%	2,819
Children Aged 0-2	4,600	4,656	4,820	5,123	1.1%	52
Children Aged 3-5	4,271	4,626	4,774	5,082	1.9%	81
Children Aged 6-12	11,113	11,040	11,445	12,500	1.2%	139
Total Children Aged 0-12	19,984	20,322	21,039	22,705	1.4%	272

Source: 2016 Census (Township Community Level Custom Data, Age in Single Years Data), Township Building Permit Data, Metro Vancouver Population Projections

The population projections indicate the number of children in the Township of Langley will continue to increase between 2020 and 2030, albeit at a more moderate rate than the previous decade. This may be indicative of lower fertility rates seen across the region and across Canada. While population growth remains positive and the number of children in the Township of Langley will continue to increase, the need for new child care spaces will be impacted by the rate at which the distinct age groups continue to grow.

HOUSEHOLDS WITH CHILDREN

When analyzing child care needs in a community, it is important to understand how many households have children. While not every household will require child care, data on the number of children per household can provide insights into which communities may have

greater or lesser needs for child care. The following table outlines the percentage of households with children in different Township communities.

Table 9: Households with Children, Township of Langley, 2016

	Aldergrove	Brookwood-Fernridge	Fort Langley	Murrayville	Rural	Walnut Grove	Willoughby	Township of Langley
Households with Children	52%	45%	43%	37%	44%	51%	55%	49%

Source: Statistics Canada, Census, 2016

Since 2006, the percentage of households with children in the Township has decreased slightly – from 50%, to 49%. Within the Township, Willoughby has the highest percentage of households with children at 55%, while Murrayville has the lowest percentage (37%).

Responses from the parent and guardian survey indicate respondents' preferred location of child care is in Willoughby¹² (39%) and Walnut Grove (23%). Currently, of all Township communities, Willoughby has the most children between the ages of 0 to 12, which is likely part of the reason more parents/guardians identified it as their preferred child care location.

INCOME

Income is an important factor to consider given the costs associated with child care. For many families, child care is a major expense, as identified through the community engagement.

Table 10 provides a summary of median income levels in the Township of Langley as a whole, as well as its communities. Median household income is highest in Fort Langley and lowest in Aldergrove. Overall, median household income in the Township (\$90,594) is higher than in Metro Vancouver (\$72,662), even for those communities in the Township with lower median income levels, such as Aldergrove.

Table 10: Median Household Income, Township of Langley, 2016

	Aldergrove	Brookwood-Fernridge	Fort Langley	Murrayville	Rural	Walnut Grove	Willoughby	Township of Langley
Median Household Income	\$76,800	\$96,127	\$112,645	\$80,172	\$89,138	\$95,000	\$91,910	\$90,594

Source: Statistics Canada, Census, 2016

¹² Willoughby includes Willowbrook.

Low-income measure after tax (LIM-AT) is tied to median income, and thus provides an indication of income inequality rather than poverty. The LIM-AT captures how many people live below 50% of the adjusted median after-tax household income, and the income thresholds are determined based on household size. Low-income after-tax cut-offs (LICO-AT) is an expenditure-based metric, adjusted to inflation. This income measure captures people or families that are expected to spend 20% or more of their after-tax income on food, shelter and clothing. The income thresholds depend on the size of the economic region. Table 11 illustrates low-income prevalence for the population between 0 to 17 years of age. Based on the LIM-AT information outlined in Table 11, there is a greater rate of income inequality among children in Metro Vancouver than in the Township of Langley.

Table 11: Low-Income Prevalence for Population Ages 0 to 17, 2016

	Local Government	2016
Prevalence of low-income (LIM-AT)	Township of Langley	12.4%
	Metro Vancouver	18.9%
Prevalence of low-income (LICO-AT)	Township of Langley	9.1%
	Metro Vancouver	15.2%

Source: Statistics Canada, Census, 2016

The LICO-AT measurement demonstrates a similar relationship, as a larger percentage of children in Metro Vancouver are in families expected to spend 20% or more of their after-tax income on necessities. Ultimately, these measurements demonstrate a lesser degree of low-income prevalence among children in the Township of Langley, as compared to Metro Vancouver. The low-income indicators are consistent with the median income data, which demonstrates households in the Township of Langley earn more than households in Metro Vancouver.

Responses from the parent and guardian survey indicate the extent to which families in the Township of Langley feel that child care is unaffordable. 54% of respondents “disagreed” or “strongly disagreed” that the fees their families pay for child care are affordable. When asked about their satisfaction with the cost of child care, responses were more mixed – of the respondents 36% indicated they were “dissatisfied” or “very dissatisfied” with the cost of child care, while 41% of respondents indicated they were “very satisfied” or “satisfied” with the cost of child care. For those families experiencing difficulty finding suitable child care, 64% of respondents identified cost as an issue. These responses are indicative of the diversity of

experience in the Township of Langley, and while affordability does not appear to be an issue for all families in the Township of Langley, it is likely an access barrier for a large number of families.

VISIBLE MINORITIES

The cultural context in the Township of Langley influences the provision of child care services, as more children from particular cultural groups that speak certain languages may increase demand for child care services that offer cultural programming. Based on a review of Census data, the percentage of the population in the Township of Langley that identifies as a visible minority has increased between 2006 (10%) and 2016 (19%). Within the Township communities, Willoughby has the highest percentage of residents who identify as a visible minority, and Fort Langley has the lowest percentage of residents who identify as a visible minority as illustrated in Table 12.

Table 12: Visible Minorities, Township of Langley, 2016

	Aldergrove	Brookwood-Fernridge	Fort Langley	Murrayville	Rural	Walnut Grove	Willoughby	Township of Langley
Visible Minority	16%	8%	6%	10%	11%	17%	34%	19%

Source: Statistics Canada, Census, 2016

Responses from the parent and guardian survey indicate there is some demand for multi-cultural programming, as 10% of respondents indicated they are looking for specialized child care with multi-cultural programming. Responses from the provider survey demonstrated that of those providers that offer specialized child care (66%), a significant percentage of respondents offer multi-cultural programming (39%).

When asked to rate their satisfaction with their current child care arrangement, 42% of respondents for whom multicultural programming was applicable indicated they were “very satisfied” or “satisfied” with multi-cultural programming. 48% of respondents were “neutral” on the topic. As per Census data, the proportion of the population that identifies as a new immigrant is relatively small (2%), which is relatively consistent with the percentage of survey participants who identified as new immigrants¹³ (5%). Given the extent to which multi-cultural programming is available and the small percentage of new immigrants in the Township, it appears there is a low need for additional multi-cultural programming.

¹³ New immigrants refers to those who have arrived in Canada in the past five years.

ABORIGINAL IDENTITY

Aboriginal identity includes persons who are First Nations (North American Indian), Metis, Inuk (Inuit), Registered or Treaty Indians (that is, registered under the Indian Act of Canada), and/or those who have membership in a First Nation or Indian band. In the Township of Langley, 4% of residents are of Aboriginal identity, which is similar to the percentage of survey participants who identified as Aboriginal (5%). Aldergrove has a slightly higher percentage of residents with Aboriginal identity, at 7%.

Table 13: Aboriginal Identity, Township of Langley, 2016

	Aldergrove	Brookwood-Fernridge	Fort Langley	Murrayville	Rural	Walnut Grove	Willoughby	Township of Langley
Aboriginal Identity	7%	5%	2%	3%	4%	3%	3%	4%

Source: Statistics Canada, Census, 2016

Responses from the parent and guardian survey indicate there is limited demand for Indigenous programming, as 2% of respondents indicated they are looking for specialized child care with Indigenous programming. When asked to rate their satisfaction with their current child care arrangement, 25% of respondents for whom Indigenous programming was applicable indicated they were “very satisfied” or “satisfied” with Indigenous programming. 64% of respondents were “neutral” on this topic.

Representatives from the Kwantlen First Nation indicated there is a need for culturally-sensitive Indigenous child care in the community. Thus, there appears to be some need for additional Indigenous programming.

LANGUAGE

In 2016, 18% of residents in the Township of Langley reported a mother tongue other than English or French, which is less than was reported in Metro Vancouver as a whole (43%). The percentage of Township residents who indicated a mother tongue other than French and English has increased from 15% in 2011. In addition to mother tongue, language spoken most often at home is another indicator that helps demonstrate the need for culturally-specific services. In 2016, 9% of Township residents reported speaking a language other than English most often at home, which is less than was reported in Metro Vancouver as a whole (28%). 3% of parent and guardian survey respondents are looking for specialized child care in a language other than English or French, and 12% of provider respondents offer

programming in languages other than English or French. This suggests there is a small need for additional programming in non-official languages.

With regard to the need for francophone-specific child care services, the parent survey responses indicate 2% of respondents identified as francophone, which is relatively consistent with the number of residents who indicated French as their mother tongue in the Census (1%). Responses from the parent and guardian survey indicate there is limited demand for francophone programming, as 4% of respondents indicated they are looking for specialized child care with francophone programming. Responses from the provider survey demonstrated that of those providers that offer specialized child care (66%), 4% of respondents offer francophone programming. Based on this information, there is a small need for additional francophone programming.

EXTRA SUPPORT NEEDS

Responses from the parent and guardian survey indicate there is some demand for extra support for children with special needs, as 14% of respondents indicated they are looking for specialized child care with extra support for children with special needs. Many Langley children¹⁴ requiring extra support are on waitlists for support workers and Supported Child Development (SCD) Consultants.¹⁵ Inclusion Langley estimates 125 children are currently waiting for a support worker and 128 children are waiting for an SCD Consultant.

When asked to rate their satisfaction with their current child care arrangement, 47% of respondents for whom programming for children requiring extra support was applicable indicated they were “very satisfied” or “satisfied” with inclusion of children requiring extra support. 43% of respondents were “neutral” on this topic. Responses from the provider survey demonstrated that of those providers that offer specialized child care (66%), the majority of respondents offer care for children with extra support needs (89%).

Based on this information, there is likely a continued need for special needs programming and a higher need for support workers and SCD Consultants.

WAITLIST DATA

The provider survey included questions related to waitlists and the number of enrolment inquiries facilities receive on a weekly basis. For the providers that do receive weekly inquiries

¹⁴ Inclusion Langley works with children across Langley - including both the Township and the City.

¹⁵ An SCD Consultant works with families and child care centres to make the child care environment successful for children with special needs.

for child care, the number of inquiries per week is highest for centres that provide care for children 30 months to school age, and infants or toddlers. On average, these providers receive 51 and 47 enquiries per week, respectively. Responses from the parent and guardian survey demonstrate many respondents are on child care waitlists, ranging from 26% on 1 waitlist to 11% on 5 or more waitlists.

The provider survey also contains information regarding the time it typically takes for parents to get a placement for their children into the respective child care program. Respondents identified a range of answers – 36% of respondents indicated an average of 7 months to 1 year, and 23% of respondents indicated an average of one to six months. This is reinforced by the information provided in the parent survey – for those respondents having difficulty finding child care, 43% of respondents indicated they are encountering challenges as no full-time spaces are available. This data demonstrates the demand for child care is outpacing supply and more licensed child care spaces are needed in the Township.

LABOUR FORCE PARTICIPATION

In the Township of Langley, the male labour force participation rate is 73%, compared to 62% for female labour force participation rate. These rates are higher than the Metro Vancouver averages of 70% for men and 61% for women. While men and women are participating in the labour force to a greater extent in the Township than across the larger region, responses from the parent and guardian survey demonstrate that 56% of respondents identified unable to “attend work” and 19% of respondents identified unable to “find work” as being the consequences of limited suitable child care. It is important to recognize a lack of child care may constrain labour force participation.

Community Engagement Highlights - What We Heard

PARENT AND STAKEHOLDER PRIORITIES

1. Affordable child care is the top priority.

Affordable child care is the top concern for parents. Child care needs to be affordable, no matter how many children are in the family. Without affordable child care, parents are limited in their ability to go to work or school, and for some, they are unable to afford to go to work at all.

2. More child care spaces are needed. Before- and after-school care is in particular need.

There are not enough child care spaces in Langley. The lack of spaces creates a stressful situation for parents as they try to find appropriate, affordable child care in the right location. Waitlists are long, costly, or even non-existent for some child care programs. When parents do not find the child care they need, it affects their ability to go to work or school. Access to school age care is the top priority in terms of the type of child care needed. Preferably, it should be on-site at the children's school with no need for children to travel to an alternate location.

3. Licensed child care is preferred.

Overwhelmingly, parents prefer licensed child care programs. In fact, 90% of parents prefer to have their children in a licensed child care facility.

4. Staff with qualifications, such as Early Childhood Education (ECE), is preferred.

Of the parents who responded to the survey, 85% prefer child care staff to hold an ECE certificate. Parents feel that well-trained staff will provide a more quality child care experience for children in a safe, reliable environment.

5. Increased flexible child care is needed.

Many parents require child care that is flexible, meaning that it is offered outside of typical business hours in the early mornings, evenings, weekends, and holidays. Flexible child care is important for:

- ▶ Parents who are commuting and often need to drop-off their children earlier than 8:00am, and often cannot pick them up until after typical child care facilities close.

- ▶ Parents working shift work who do not always have consistent work days (rotating shifts), often working long days (up to 12 hour shifts), or hours that are not the typical (outside of 9:00am - 5:00pm). People in these situations are finding it almost impossible to find child care.

6. Families want healthy, safe, quality child care.

Families want child care programs that provide a healthy and safe environment, offering quality programming, staffing, and facilities.

For many families, the lack of options for child care results in a lack of choice. Some parents feel like they have no other choice than to leave their children in the only child care option available to them, regardless of the quality and safety of the program or staff. If there was another affordable choice of child care available that was higher quality, they would take it.

7. Subsidies are important for everyone, and need to be easy to access.

Currently, there are several provincial programs to help reduce child care fees for families. The Affordable Child Care Benefit is available for eligible families, the Child Care Fee Reduction Initiative (CCFRI) provides funding directly to child care providers, and the Young Parent Program for parents under the age of 25 while they finish high school. There are currently no Universal Child Care Prototype Sites (low-cost spaces where families pay no more than \$200 a month) in Langley.

For families who are accessing child care subsidies, it makes a big difference to their budget. Some parents indicated that without the subsidies, they would have been unable to return to work or school.

8. Parents want child care to be located close to home or at their child's school.

Parents would like to have child care in close proximity to their home, and, if children are in school, close to their elementary school. The third option preferred by parents is to have child care close to their place of work or school.

UNDERSERVED FAMILIES

Targeted Parent Meetings were held for families who may be particularly underserved in terms of child care. The participants included families needing extra support, low-income families, young parents under the age of 25, children and families from minority cultures and language groups, and immigrant and refugee children and families. We heard from underserved families that:

1. Affordable child care is often needed, even when a parent is not working. This gives the parent a chance to run errands or attend appointments.
2. Inadequate child care can result in involuntary unemployment, underemployment, and no other choice but to turn down career or education opportunities.
3. Lack of choice in child care can result in parents compromising on health, safety, quality, or preferences.
4. Some parents face transportation challenges, making location preferences very important.
5. Some parents need flexible or part-time child care.
6. Child care for children with special needs is lacking. If it is available, it is very limited, and expensive.

CHILD CARE PROVIDER PRIORITIES

1. **Finding and retaining qualified staff is the top priority.** The number one issue for child care providers is finding enough qualified staff. In order to retain staff providers need to be able to pay competitive wages and provide ongoing training opportunities.
2. **Affordable and appropriate facilities are needed to develop child care programs.** In order to provide quality and affordable child care, providers are in need of facilities they can afford. Child care buildings need to be safe, appropriate, and have enough outdoor space for children to play. Finding enough outdoor space can be difficult in areas that are primarily commercial buildings.
3. **Municipal processes should support and encourage the development of child care.** Municipalities that encourage and support the development of new child care spaces could remove barriers for providers (eg. zoning, fees, etc). This type of support will enable providers to not only create new child care spaces, but to also create more affordable spaces.

- 4. Provincial licensing requirements should support and encourage the development of child care.** Rules and guidelines for licensed child care facilities are found in the Community Care and Assisted Living Act, the Child Care Licensing Regulation, and the standards of practice. Licensing officers from the local health authority monitor each child care facility. Providers identified specific licensing requirements that do not support the development of new child care spaces, in particular, for in-home child care programs. Providers would like certain requirements to be flexible or negotiable depending on unique circumstances.

Refer to the Phase One Community Engagement Report for a complete summary of the engagement results.

Child Care Strengths, Gaps, and Trends

A series of strengths, gaps, and trends related to child care in the Township were identified from the background research, data analysis, and community engagement.

Availability of Child Care

According to the Ministry of Children and Family Development, Langley parents and guardians experience “significant difficulty” accessing group infant/toddler care (under 3 years of age) and “some difficulty” accessing group care for children aged 3 to 5 (no rating is provided for children aged 6 to 12).¹⁶ Coverage rates (i.e. the number of spaces available per 100 children) demonstrate there are not sufficient spaces available to meet the needs of families in the Township, particularly for children under 3 years of age, and between 6 to 12 years of age. It is also important to note coverage rates vary within Township communities.

Survey feedback demonstrates 36% of respondents currently have child care, 26% currently have care and are looking for new or additional child care services, 25% do not currently have care but need care, and 13% do not need child care. For those respondents on child care waitlists, 33% of respondents are on 1 waitlist, 27% of respondents are on 2 waitlists, 20% of respondents are on 3 waitlists, 6% are on 4 waitlists, and 14% are on 5+ waitlists. During engagement, parents indicated they are on waitlists for care and may have to pay a waitlist fee.

The child care provider survey found that 72% of respondents receive weekly enquiries for 30 month to school age care, and 66% of respondents receive weekly enquiries for infant/toddler care. Feedback received at the provider workshop further confirms waitlists are common and many families are on waitlists for child care. This is indicative of the extent of need in the Township – there are insufficient spaces to meet demand. Additionally, 68% of respondents “disagree” or “strongly disagree” that there is an adequate supply of all forms of child care services in Langley.

For respondents experiencing difficulty finding suitable child care, challenges include no full-time space availability, no part-time space availability, no occasional space availability, and lack of quality care. A majority of respondents indicated it is “very important” or “important” that child care is licensed (83%), similar to the percentage of respondents that feel it is “very

¹⁶ These ratings are based on child care utilization rates for the Langley Local Service Area, which includes both the Township and City.

important" or "important" for child care staff to have an early childhood education (ECE) Certificate (77%). Feedback received through the parent survey indicates 8% of respondents are using licence-not-required child care, 4% are using in-child's-own-home care, and 14% are using unpaid care provided by an extended family member or friend.

Cost of Child Care

The cost of child care is substantive, and feedback received during consultation indicates cost is frequently a major barrier for families and may limit both the extent to which children are in care and parents or guardians are able to participate in the labour force.

The results of the parent and guardian survey indicate most parents are paying up to \$1,000 per month per child, while some parents are spending over \$2,000. Survey results indicate only 10% of respondents budget more than \$1,000 on monthly child care costs. Findings from engagement indicate cost is a major issue both for families and providers. For underserved families, cost was the number one priority expressed during targeted parent meetings.

Provincial child care subsidies are available for families, such as the Child Care Fee Reduction Initiative and the Affordable Child Care Benefit. 54% of parent and guardian survey respondents are currently receiving a child care subsidy. Of those receiving a subsidy, 49% do not receive enough to make up the difference between their ability to pay and the cost of child care. Consultation with underserved families focused on the cost of child care and the compromises that must be made when care is not affordable or accessible.

Provider respondents were asked to identify which additional supports they provide to families, and the first and second most frequently identified options were the Child Care Fee Reduction Initiative and the BC Affordable Child Care Benefit. While some providers are able to access subsidies and provide support with the cost of care, survey responses and feedback received during consultation demonstrate affordability is still a significant barrier for many families who wish to access child care.

Location of Child Care

Current best practices emphasize the potential benefits afforded through co-location of child care facilities with schools, municipal facilities, and commercial buildings in proximity to office districts. For parents and guardians with young children, a site with both an elementary school and a child care facility can significantly minimize transportation time. Respondents

who are experiencing difficulty finding suitable child care were asked to identify what challenges they are encountering, and could choose multiple answers. 28% of respondents specified “too far from home”, 35% indicated “too far from the school that my child(ren) attends”, and 17% chose “too far from my work or school”. Respondents were also asked if they found child care services close to different locations - the highest percentage of respondents (45%) found child care close to home, followed by 25% of respondents who found child care close to “my child(ren)’s elementary school”, and 13% of respondents who found child care close to “my place of employment”.

The child care provider survey indicates 34% of provider respondents are co-located on the same site as elementary schools. In addition to co-locating child care with elementary schools, feedback from community consultation indicates there is a need to consider co-locating child care with community centres and recreational facilities, including libraries.

Location challenges were particularly pronounced for underserved families, highlighting the importance of locating child care facilities close to transit. This is also important for child care providers and staff.

Parents and guardians emphasized the importance and convenience of the Township’s Active Beyond the Bell program, which is an after-school recreation program mostly provided at elementary schools. While Beyond the Bell is a recreation program, it fills an important after-school child care need for school-aged children. Feedback received during consultation acknowledged the popularity of this program, and many parents expressed interest in extended hours (i.e. after 5pm, before school) and additional locations.

In order to locate child care in areas close to families’ homes, it is important to understand existing coverage rates and where growth is occurring. Willoughby is growing quickly, as demonstrated by Township population estimates and the parent responses regarding their preferred child care location.

Most growth will likely continue to take place in Willoughby in the short to medium term, with some redistribution to Brookwood-Fernridge in the medium to long term. It will be important to monitor population change and ensure new child care facilities are located in areas with greatest need, in proximity to transit, and close to elementary schools and places of employment.

Flexibility of Child Care

Feedback received from parents and guardians during engagement indicates there is a desire for greater flexibility of child care, which corresponds to mornings, evenings, and holidays. When asked what times child care is usually required, 54% of respondents indicated early mornings (6:00am - 8:00am), 59% specified morning (8:00am - 12:00pm), 60% chose afternoon (12:00pm - 3:00pm), and 80% specified late afternoon (3:00pm - 6:00pm). A smaller percentage (6%) of respondents chose evenings (6:00pm - 11:00pm), and 0.6% usually require care overnight (11:00pm - 6:00am). 5% of respondents are flexible on the times they need child care.

A majority of respondents have child care at the times/days they require (77%), yet parents requiring more flexible care do not have options that meet their needs. Approximately one-third of respondents (32%) are “dissatisfied” or “very dissatisfied” with care offered in early mornings, evenings, and weekends while 15% of respondents are “dissatisfied” or “very dissatisfied” with general hours of care. Flexible care is important - 24% of respondents indicated their child care needs vary week to week or month to month and 11% of respondents are flexible on the days they need child care.

The provider survey reflects this context, as only 2% of respondents offer care on Saturdays, 0% on Sundays, and 1% on statutory holidays. A substantial percentage of respondents provide care in early mornings (70%), while a very limited percentage of respondents provide care in evenings (3%). These responses illustrate that the current child care system in the Township of Langley predominantly serves parents requiring care on weekdays, between 8:00am – 6:00pm.

Child Care for Children Requiring Extra Support

Consultation activities indicated a need for continued special needs programming and additional support for children with special needs. Feedback from the providers survey demonstrates 89% of providers offer care for children with extra support needs, and 14% of parent respondents are looking for specialized child care with extra support for a child with special needs. For those respondents for whom “inclusion of children requiring extra support” is applicable, 90% of respondents are “very satisfied”, “satisfied”, or “neutral” with the inclusion of children requiring extra support. This demonstrates there is high satisfaction among respondents with the existing support programs; however, additional support is needed, as per waitlist information from Inclusion Langley.

Many Langley children¹⁷ requiring extra support are on waitlists for support workers and Supported Child Development Consultants.¹⁸ Inclusion Langley estimates 125 children are currently waiting for a support worker and 128 children are waiting for an SCD Consultant. This indicates there is a need for more support workers and SCD Consultants. Feedback from engagement with providers specified recruiting and retaining qualified staff was a challenge, which has resulted in waitlists for children requiring extra support as staff aren't available.

The parent survey asked respondents what forms of specialized child care they are looking for, and parents predominantly identified outdoor or nature programming and play-based programming. With regard to other forms of specialized child care, 11% of provider respondents offer Indigenous programming, 39% of provider respondents offer multi-cultural programming, and 12% of provider respondents offer programming in languages other than English or French. For those respondents for whom "multicultural programming" is applicable, 90% of respondents are "very satisfied", "satisfied", or "neutral" with multicultural programming. For those respondents for whom "Indigenous programming" is applicable, 88% of respondents are "very satisfied", "satisfied", or "neutral" with multicultural programming.

Staffing

Engagement sessions highlighted the challenges that providers experience in recruiting and retaining qualified child care staff. At the provider workshop, attendees referenced several issues related to staffing including low wages, competition for staffing among providers, and general challenges related to recruitment and retention. When asked what prevents providers from supplying more child care spaces, staffing challenges was the second most-often chosen reason following space limitations. There are only a few number of schools that offer ECE programs, and for those individuals who may wish to pursue an ECE certificate, the cost and time off from work is difficult to justify, given the limited earning potential. Of the parents who responded to the survey, 85% prefer child care staff to hold an ECE certificate. Parents feel that well-trained staff will provide a more quality child care experience for children in a safe, reliable environment.

¹⁷ Inclusion Langley works with children across Langley - including both the Township and the City.

¹⁸ An SCD Consultant works with families and child care centres to make the child care environment successful for children with special needs.

Suitable Facilities for Providers

Feedback from child care providers indicated they are challenged to afford the cost of facilities which limits their ability to provide care. Regulations and requirements can limit the spaces that can be used for child care (e.g. outdoor play area requirements) and can make renovations costly (e.g. sprinkler systems). Comments received reflect these concerns – *“The spaces I have looked at to create a group centre – it costs too much to renovate to regulations, specifically sprinklers and outdoor space”*. A majority of providers (62%) indicated space limitations prevent them from providing more child care spaces. Survey feedback indicates facilities are predominantly leased or owned, with a smaller percentage operating out of residential buildings. During the provider workshop, attendees explained that some leases can create uncertainty, it is difficult to find adequate facilities, and available facilities are expensive. Survey comments received indicate the extent to which facility affordability is a challenge for providers – *“Too challenging to find affordable locations!”*, *“Cost of appropriate facilities”*.

Policy and Regulatory Framework

The Township’s Official Community Plan currently includes some policy regarding the location of child care, but there appears to be opportunities for a more robust policy framework and enhanced consistency across community and neighbourhood plans.

Child care is permitted in many residential zones, which is key to ensuring providers are able to offer care in their homes. The Township also allows for non-resident staff in many home-based child care facilities, providing additional support for individuals offering care from their homes. That said, feedback received from consultation indicates the existing regulatory framework may pose challenges for certain providers, and a fulsome review to identify unintended barriers could be beneficial to the creation of additional child care spaces. In addition, some providers also indicated that the Fraser Health Authority licensing and Township permitting and licensing processes can be confusing, as the role of each organization is sometimes unclear.

Lastly, responses received from the provider survey and feedback provided during the provider workshop indicated that provincial licensing regulations can be challenging. Comments received indicated *“ECE staff necessary for opening and closing”*, *“Need to go commercial to take more kids”*, and *“Too many limits on age”*. Providers expressed interest in different incentives to encourage child care (e.g. fee waivers, parking relaxations).

Partnerships and Collaboration

Multiple parties have a role in child care, and successful programming requires collaboration and communication among the many relevant stakeholders. There are a number of community planning tables and liaison groups that can be leveraged to strengthen information-sharing and collaboration on child care, including:

- ★ The Langley Children Committee, and its Child Care Working Group, which is a cross-sector collaboration group focused on early and middle childhood.
- ★ The Langley Healthier Community Partnership Steering Committee, which is co-chaired by the Township, Langley City, and Fraser Health and fosters cross-sector collaboration on community health and well-being.
- ★ The Langley Township - Langley School District liaison committees, which meet to discuss areas of mutual interest.

Data Monitoring

To track progress towards the space creation targets and identify emerging needs, it is essential to regularly monitor data, including the number of child care spaces. Currently, space creation numbers are not regularly tracked by the Township of Langley; however, the data is available from Fraser Health Authority, and additional collaboration and communication can help to ensure this information is monitored.

Anticipated Systems Change

The provincial government has committed to a universal child care system, and is in the process of several pilot projects to test funding and operational models of this new system. The Universal Child Care Prototype Sites provide low-cost care to families across the province – currently over 50 sites are in operation across the province. In addition, an Inclusion Pilot Project was launched to explore new approaches to including children with extra support needs in child care programs. As this transition begins to unfold, it will be important to determine the implications for the current child care arrangements and structures established in the Township of Langley.

